

FINAL REPORT

Eighth

General Service Conference

of A. A.



1958

CONFIDENTIAL

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SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

Promise and Progress Were Keynotes

The 1958 General Service Conference was perhaps the most stimulating and the most searching in the history of these annual meetings of A.A. representatives from the United States, its possessions and Canada. The stimulus was apparent in the frank and vigorous manner in which Delegates discussed a number of vital issues. The searching—frank, revealing and penetrating—was for ways to reconcile divergent viewpoints in determining policies that will assure the future sound growth of the Fellowship.

To a casual observer, had any been present at the Conference, it might have seemed that the Delegates were having "trouble" in reaching that unity and agreement on basic issues that is the distinctive hallmark of A.A. To Bill W., our co-founder, the superficial evidence of "trouble" was clear proof that deeper and more constructive forces were at work.

Converted 'Trouble' To Asset

"I think that this particular meeting bespeaks more promise and progress for A.A. than any that have gone on before," Bill told the Delegates at the closing session on Sunday. "It holds promise and has been filled with progress *because* it has had 'trouble.' And it has converted that 'trouble' into an asset, into growth and into a great promise."

A.A. was born out of trouble, "one of the most serious kinds of trouble that can beset an individual," Bill recalled. "It has taken a virtual miracle of the grace of God to raise each of us out of our bondage. Then the miracle stage is over and there follows this question of facing life, of living and growing and working together, of carrying our message to the world, of becoming citizens of the world worthy of the name."

Bill suggested the parallel between problems presented to the 1958 Conference and problems which had confronted the Society in its early days of growth.

Need Both 'Absolute' and 'Relative'

"We had quarrels about money," he noted. "We had quarrels about prestige. We had the bitterest quarrels over the most magnificent passages in the A.A. book. Out of those conflicts, out of that 'trouble,' came an education. Even out of the problems that had arisen before the book was written had come an education, an application of divine principles that makes the book what it is. If we had not had any trouble, we could not have had any book. So it takes the absolute and the relative, the divine and the sordid to make that very important product: progress."

Bill pointed out that movement-wide acceptance of A.A. Tradition, "and it came along very slowly," was itself the product of educational, constructive trouble that led to growth. So, too, he noted, was the concept of the Conference, which had to be set within the framework of A.A. Tradition.

Perhaps the most-widely discussed session of the 1958 Conference was the closed meeting staged by the Area Delegates

Friday evening. By tradition, only Area Delegates to the Conference attend these sessions which this year were reported to have featured vigorous and vociferous debate.

Referring to this meeting, Bill said he had been pleased, not alarmed, to learn that the discussions had been quite lively. "When I learned about the meetings," Bill told the Delegates, "I said 'fine!' We are going to learn something. This is wonderful!"

Bill identified the spirit of the 1958 Conference with the spirit of democracy to which the Fellowship adheres.

"I think all of us revere the concepts of democracy and of parliaments and of the Republic. We see and approve these associations of men and women trying to cooperate, trying to govern themselves. We in the Western world believe that in these institutions lies the spiritual substance necessary for the ultimate happiness and unity of the world. We believe deeply in parliaments, in the Republic, in the spirit of democracy.

Need Sound Motivation

"Here, we believe in the same things for A.A. Now, if this Conference was ruffled, if individuals were deeply disturbed, I say: 'This is fine. For what parliament, what Republic, what democracy, has not been disturbed?' Friction of opposing viewpoints is part of the very *modus operandi* on which they proceed. What should we be afraid of here?"

Bill said that the "great hope" of democracies, republics and parliaments is that the people "back in the constituencies" will be sufficiently well-motivated, will be sufficiently well-informed, will be sufficiently spiritual, to make these institutions work. The alternative, he suggested, was the "childish device" of dictatorship.

In their open and frank approach to many of the topics discussed at the 1958 Conference, the Delegates unquestionably disclosed that their sole motivation was the continuing welfare of Alcoholics Anonymous throughout the world as well as in their own Areas. They reflected a movement that is increasingly well-informed concerning many serious issues affecting the movement, although the degree of information is not uniform throughout the Fellowship. Finally, despite the vigor and zeal with which many viewpoints were pressed, it was clearly apparent that spiritual considerations, rather than material elements, were at the roots of nearly every presentation.

Legacies To Successors

Progress? The evidence is on the record on virtually each following page, testifying not only to the Delegates' deliberations but to the year-round work of A.A.'s major service agencies.

Promise? The Fellowship's commitments to itself and those it hopes to serve are equally clear.

Fundamentally, this was an instructive, a fruitful Conference. For promise and progress are perhaps the greatest legacies that one Conference can bequeath to its successors—and to the movement as a whole.

New Trustee Ratio Formula Approved

Perhaps the most significant action of the Conference was its approval of the principle of changing the ratio of Trustees of the General Service Board (now eight non-alcoholics and seven A.A. members) to nine alcoholics and nine non-alcoholics.

This agreement was reached with the understanding that the proposed change will be submitted to the Areas for review prior to a formal vote at the 1959 Conference.

Proposals to change the Trustee ratio date back to the first Conference in 1951 and have been discussed at virtually all subsequent gatherings of Delegates. At various times Bill W., co-founder, has suggested that a change in the current ratio would be desirable. The same suggestion has been advanced by non-alcoholic Trustees who are now in a majority.

Proposal Debated Seriously

The formula approved by 1958 Delegates (by a 65-to-12 majority) was presented by Bernard B. Smith, non-alcoholic Trustee who for many years was chairman of the Board of Trustees. Mr. Smith recalled that at one time he had urged that non-alcoholic Trustees be a minority of the Board. He said that he now felt that, in the absence of an overwhelming demand to reverse the present ratio, no such radical action should be taken. His "nine-and-nine" formula was offered, he said, as a means of enhancing the dignity of A.A. representation on the Board.

The proposal was debated seriously and with deep conviction by Delegates and Trustees on both sides of the question. By the close of the Conference, it was clear that the "Smith formula" was acceptable to a substantial majority of the Delegates and that all Delegates were better-informed than ever before and thus able to pave the way in their Areas for a satisfactory resolution of the problem at the 1959 Conference.

Excerpts from viewpoints presented during the discussion follow:

For Maintaining the Present Ratio

"A poll of all former Delegates to the General Service Conference shows that 169 do NOT want a majority of alcoholics on the Board of Trustees while only 67 would like to see such a change. And if these people are not informed on A.A. matters, then no one is.

"The largest industrial and business firms in the world have a majority of men not from the field of their endeavor on their Boards of Trustees. Banks do not have . . . Bell System telephone companies do not have . . . the Coca Cola Company does not have . . . the Southern Baptist Investment Corporation, the largest investment real estate board in the world, does not have a majority of Baptists . . . the Santa Fe Railway and the Southern Railway specify that at no time shall their boards of directors be composed of a majority of railroad men . . .

"The General Service Board, as presently constituted, saved the movement three times, according to Bill. That is the record.

"The greatest public relations we have ever had or ever will have are the eight non-alcoholics we have on the present Board.

"Where, within the movement itself, could we possibly find men with the ability, capacity and public position that our non-alcoholic friends on the Board of Trustees have? These men are devoting their time and effort to A.A., time and effort that is worth thousands upon thousands of dollars.

"What right do we have to change the present ratio in the absence of a clear demand for change?

"Alcoholics actually do—in the Conference and in the Board—handle their own affairs right now. There is actually always a working majority of alcoholics at Board meetings."

For Changing the Present Ratio

"There is no national organization which does not have responsibility vested in a majority of those whom it serves. This is basic to sound operations.

"Actually as we look at A.A. as a national structure, which it is in one respect, we are completely out of step with the usual procedures followed in our own and other countries.

"Isn't it interesting that the only place we think we are incompetent is at the top? No local groups bring a majority of people in from the outside and ask them to conduct the group's affairs.

"The interesting thing is that when we do come to a matter of interpretation of what A.A. policy should be, the non-alcoholic Trustees feel that they are not competent to discuss such matters and they do not take action. So the actual decisions affecting A.A. are being made very largely by the majority of alcoholic members of the Board.

"We should act now as a 23-year-old organization, with membership throughout the world, and as though we were now competent to assume full responsibility for our General Service Office.

"The alcoholic does not begin to recover until he stands on his own feet and begins to take responsibility before the world for his actions.

"Broadening of the representation of alcoholics on the Board would be helpful in reaching decisions under the 9-and-9 proposal."

1960 Convention

Long Beach, California, was approved by the Conference as the site for an International A.A. Convention to be held the weekend of July 1-3, 1960. This decision is subject to final review of facilities available in Long Beach and, as is traditional, must be confirmed by the General Service Board.

The city of San Francisco had been a pre-Conference candidate for the 1960 convention. Delegates from the various California Areas agreed by lot to offer the single candidacy of Long Beach. A.A. members in Akron, Ohio, also were interested in being hosts to a world get-together in 1960.

It was agreed that supervision of programming and public relations for the convention would be retained by the General Service Board and that all costs would be underwritten by the host Area or Areas. Any excess of income over expenses would be turned over to G.S.B.

The Conference voted to constitute an Advisory Convention Committee on the following basis: Three members each from panels 7, 8, 9 and 10, plus the California Delegates, with the understanding that one Committee member will be a Canadian and that members chosen from panels 9 and 10 (1959 and 1960) will come from Areas not already represented.

Members chosen by lot to serve on the Committee are: Wes Parrish, South Florida; Tom Anderson, South Jersey; Bill Henderson, Northeast Texas; Bill Wallace, Kentucky; Carl Simon, Wisconsin and Ian MacLeod, Atlantic Provinces. California members are: Paul Gardner, Northern Coastal Countries; Ben Edgerton, San Diego; and Duane Rolofson, Northern Interior Counties, with Glenn Christianson, Los Angeles, and Stan Wilsey, San Francisco, co-chairmen.

Delegates' Term, Numbers

As at several earlier Conferences, 1958 Delegates discussed in some detail the question of extending the present two-year term of Delegates to three years and the related subject of increasing the present number of Area Delegates.

One Delegate made a strong presentation, based on research showing the trend toward enlargement of the U. S. Congress, against increasing the number of Conference Delegates from presently constituted Areas.

He was challenged with equal vigor by a California Delegate who demonstrated that additional representation from his State was warranted on a population basis as set forth in the Third Legacy Manual.

Subsequent discussion disclosed sentiment for proceeding with caution in enlarging the Conference without denying adequate representation to qualified Areas. Several Delegates suggested that more effective use of Committeemen was one answer to the problem of Conference coverage in many areas.

The Admissions Committee approved the seating of a fifth California Delegate at future Conferences.

Few Delegates appeared to feel that it would now serve the interests of the Society to extend Delegates' terms of service. Smoother continuity in relations between G.S.O. and individual Areas can be achieved by acquainting Committeemen (potential Delegates) with Conference procedures and responsibilities, it was suggested.

The Policy Committee reached no conclusion on the subject of extended terms of service, recommending that Panel 7 Delegates be polled for their opinions.

Institutional Groups

One of the most interesting matters to come before the 1958 Conference involved the question of whether or not the Delegates felt that prison and hospital groups should participate in Area Assemblies. Such participation is already a reality in several Areas but this topic had never previously been aired at a Conference session.

A Delegate from an Area where the institutional participation plan is being tested reported that it has been generally successful to date. In this Area, the sponsor of the institutional group obtains a proxy from the group and registers it at the opening of the Area Assembly.

Another Delegate, a former member of an institutional group, suggested that matters to be reviewed at an Assembly should be discussed with the institutional group in advance, and the group's desires on specific issues ascertained. Inmate members were inclined to be suspicious, he said, and might not like the idea of granting "blank" proxies for an "outsider" to use as the latter saw fit.

The sense of the Conference appeared to be that it would be unwise for the Delegates to take a formal stand on this matter at this time and that the question should be left to the discretion of individual Area Assemblies.

The question was therefore referred to the Policy Committee whose report supporting the principle of local autonomy was adopted unanimously.

Book Reprint Rejected

At nearly every one of the seven preceding Conferences one or more Delegates have suggested that a "paperback" edition of the "Big Book" would be a useful addition to the Fellowship's literature. On each occasion Bill or a member of the G.S.O. staff have explained that such a venture might have serious effects on the financing of A.A. world services, and no formal action had ever been taken on the suggestion.

This year, when the question of a paperback edition was raised by an ex-Delegate, at the request of his Area, prior to the Conference, Bill set forth in detail in a 14-page memorandum (March 22, 1958) the reasons why he believed such a project would not be in the best interests of the Society. This memorandum was then submitted to the Conference for its formal opinion.

Bill's major reasons:

1. A fifty-cent reprint edition might detract seriously from sales of the standard edition, with serious consequences to G. S. O.
2. The need for "cheap" literature describing A.A. is being filled through the Society's large line of pamphlet literature.
3. The cost of the standard edition does not appear to be a barrier to its distribution, since any interested person can obtain access to a copy by a loan, through installment plan purchase or in a local library.
4. There is no assurance that a cheap reprint would sell well.

After brief discussion the Conference voted not to consider publication of a paperback edition of the "Big Book."

Following this, Bill authorized general distribution of his memorandum, with specific reference to the Area in which the request for a paperback edition had been made.

Territorial Delegates

A.A. members in Alaska were represented at the 1958 Conference for the first time. Members in Puerto Rico were represented for the third time. Not all 1958 Delegates were aware, however, that these fellow-representatives came from Areas which were required to pay their full travel expenses, with only their room and board in New York being covered by G.S.O.

When this fact became known during the course of discussion on Delegates' terms of service, it soon became apparent that this year's Conference was opposed to such treatment of qualified Delegates outside of the U. S. and Canada. (A similar policy would have applied to a representative from Hawaii, had a Delegate been named from that Territory.)

After brief discussion, the Delegates referred this matter to the Committees on Finance and on Policy. The latter committee's report, adopted unanimously, recommended "that accredited Delegates from U. S. Territories, possessions and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico should receive the same financial considerations as the Delegates from the U. S. and Canada, as these Delegates have been accepted by the Conference as a part of the Conference structure."

Chips, Tokens & Emblems

For the first time in the history of the Conference, Delegates were asked to record the attitude of the movement as a whole toward the use of so-called A.A. "chips," "tokens," "lapel emblems" and similar devices.

Discussion from the floor indicated that items of this type are extremely popular in certain Areas while they are used little or not at all in other sections of the U. S. and Canada. In one Area, chips are awarded for three, five and twelve months of sobriety.

Several Delegates reported their dislike of the use of the World Directory by manufacturers who solicit the groups for business of this type.

The consensus was that this was a matter for local autonomy and not one on which the Conference should record a definite position in behalf of the movement.

This attitude was endorsed by the Literature Committee to whom the matter was referred for further study.

Anonymity Mailing

Widespread distribution, in the near future, of an "anonymity resolution" similar to that approved by the movement at the 20th Anniversary Convention in 1955 was endorsed by the Conference, following a suggestion by the Public Information Committee of the G. S. B.

The mailing will be directed to key communications executives (press, radio, television, films) in the U. S. and Canada and will express A.A.'s awareness of the help the movement has received from all media. It will be cleared with legal counsel and any indicated changes are to be made, subject to approval of the Board of Trustees.

'Grapevine' Circulation

A "middle-of-the-road" plan of circulation stimulation for the A.A. *Grapevine* was approved by the Conference, following a detailed and lengthy presentation by personnel responsible for the monthly journal's financial and editorial policies.

A special program designed to encourage present *Grapevine* readers to secure at least one additional subscription from other members will be tested in a representative A.A. Area. Delegates and Committeemen in other Areas will be encouraged to participate in this campaign.

Circulation Increased in 1956

Excerpts from the *Grapevine* presentation follow:

"By a very great effort, and the expenditure of \$15,000 in promotion during the last quarter of 1955 and all of 1956, circulation of the *Grapevine* was jumped from 31,000 to 41,000. In July, 1957, the number of pages was increased from 48 to 64 and the price from 25 cents to 35 cents. However we lost 5,000 of our circulation, despite the fact that a limited survey shows that readers like the present magazine. From July through Christmas, 1957, promotion was continued at a cost of \$4,600. Since then there has been virtually no promotion and the circulation loss has continued."

Maintained Cash Position

"The present financial picture is poor, but not critical. Despite its operating loss, the magazine has substantially maintained its cash position since last July."

"Had we done nothing about improving, enlarging and adding to the staff of the *Grapevine* in 1957, and had we kept the price at 25 cents, the loss would have been \$5,000 for the year. Despite the large circulation rise of the previous year inflation had caught up with us that badly."

Calculations Based on 42,000

"Our calculations (in making the July, 1957, improvements) were based, however, on the hope that the circulation could be maintained at 42,000, about where it was last July. This would have broken us even in the first quarter of 1958 and would have shown us a profit by next July. Instead, we have lost 5,000 in circulation and may lose more. Like lots of carefully-considered business estimates, ours went wrong."

The Conference recommended that during the coming year the *Grapevine* occasionally publish editions of 48 pages rather than 64 pages, "when feasible and necessary in the judgement of the *Grapevine* Board of Directors."

Intensive Promotion Opposed

Delegates also approved a statement acknowledging that it may not be possible for the *Grapevine* to "pay its own way" for some time.

"Heavy, intensive" circulation promotion programs were opposed by the Delegates who, however, recommended that some form of continuous "reminders" be used as needed and at the discretion of the magazine's Board of Directors.

'Census' of Membership

How many members does A.A. actually have? How closely does "reported" membership, recorded in the World Directory on the basis of figures submitted by the groups, approximate a true count of the number of men and women who have recovered from alcoholism in A.A.?

One of the notable decisions of the 1958 Conference authorized both the Delegates and the General Service Office to undertake a "census" of the Fellowship. The actual census-taking will be done by the groups themselves and Delegates were urged to stress the need for, and importance of, such a project in their reports to Areas.

G.S.O. will cooperate by publicizing the proposed census in the September issue of the *Exchange Bulletin*.

The most recent reported membership, including certain projections for groups which do not register membership with G.S.O., is slightly less than 140,000. It is believed, however, that actual membership, including persons presently sober who have stopped attending group meetings, may be substantially higher.

Bill W.'s Status

The status of Bill W., co-founder of A.A., in relation to the Fellowship was clarified in two respects at the 1958 Conference.

The first point of clarification was requested directly by Bill in a letter to Delegates in which he pointed out that several future courses were open to him, ranging from complete disassociation from A.A. service matters to continuing participation in the number of unfinished projects which he feels are important to the welfare of the movement.

On this point the Conference voted unanimously to ask Bill to provide continuing leadership on all projects of movement-wide concern in which he is currently interested.

In a second vote, the Conference approved the action of the General Service Board in re-assigning to Bill royalty rights in his three books (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*), and in books he may write in the future, for the duration of the copyrights involved. Bill has declared his intention to have these royalty rights revert to the movement when the copyrights expire.

P. O. Boxes

All Delegates were asked by G.S.O. to recognize the importance of a permanent group mailing address as a means of maintaining liaison between the groups and the Service Office and between groups themselves.

The Conference approved a proposal that all Delegates stress this matter in their Area reports and urge that groups obtain a post office box as their mailing address whenever practicable.

G. S. O. Financial Support

A special (General Service Board) Subcommittee on Fund Raising submitted the following recommendations to the Conference:

1. That a pilot plan to be set up in selected Areas where Conference personnel wished to assume responsibility for collecting a locally-established (\$2 per member per year) quota for support of world services.

2. That a pledge plan for group contributions be tested by volunteer Delegates and/or committeemen.

3. That a pilot plan for obtaining *individual* contributions be established, based on contacts with close friends in the Fellowship who may not be as active as formerly. (All contacts to be cleared through master file at G.S.O. *in advance*).

4. That a "Birthday Plan experience file" be opened at G.S.O., for further consideration in 1959.

The Conference discussed these proposals in detail, then referred them to its Finance Committee. The Committee's report, fully supporting the recommendations, was adopted unanimously by the Delegates. (See page 23)

'Area Delegates Only'

The following summarizes actions taken at the meeting for Area Delegates Only, Friday evening.

1. The Chairman for the 1959 Area Delegates Only Meeting was chosen by lot at the opening of the session. The Delegate is Willard J. Monson, Manitoba, Canada.
2. It was recommended that the reports of the *Grapevine* staff at future Conferences be limited to two hours with primary emphasis on financial data and operating trends. Serious concern over the present size of the *Grapevine* staff, relative to its duties and the present financial status of the corporation was expressed. (Referred to *Grapevine* Committee.)
3. It was recommended that no change be made in the Delegate's term of office as presently suggested in the Third Legacy Manual. (Panel 7 Delegates to be polled.)
4. The Delegates recommend to the Conference as a whole that in the future the expenses of qualified Delegates from Puerto Rico, Alaska and Hawaii be handled in the same manner as the expenses of other qualified Delegates.
5. The Area Delegates approved the principle of changing the ratio of the Trustees of the General Service Board to comprise nine alcoholics and nine non-alcoholics, with the understanding that a proposal covering the recommended change be sent to the areas for thorough discussion preliminary to final determination of this matter at the 1959 Conference.
6. The Delegates express to the General Service Office Staff their confidence in the judgment shown in selecting the site of the 1958 Conference and recommend that arrangements for the 1959 Conference similarly be left to the judgment of the General Service Office Staff.

General Service Conference

(Hazel R.)

Our Third Legacy has grown to be much more than a "suggested method" for electing Delegates and Committee members. It is fast becoming A. A.'s "living spirit" of Service.

A high percentage of the Delegates have taken seriously their responsibility to the movement and have "carried the message" of A. A.'s Twelve Traditions of Unity and World Service to all sections of the North American Continent.

Through this service, the General Service Board and General Service Conference have been greatly strengthened and A. A. seems assured of survival.

General Service Conference Committees were increasingly active and effective. Trends during the past year included the following:

1. Chairman of Area Committee separate from Delegate. This lightens the work-load for each and seems to strengthen the Conference locally.
2. Decrease of size of districts. Increase in number of Area Committee members. Thus, Committee members have truly "workable" districts.
3. Regularly-scheduled Area Committee meetings either monthly, bi-monthly or quarterly. (Dependent on geography involved).
4. Committee meetings rotated geographically. (The second portion of the Committee meeting becomes a district meeting with all GSRs and any interested A. A.s in the Area invited. Traditions or a phase of world service are discussed, plus an A. A. speaker. This has proved a popular means of attracting A. A.s. Also: a good "spot" for the Conference Report.)

5. Committee members gave detailed reports on their work in their districts.
6. Assembly meetings scheduled at least every six months in a number of Areas. Unity and service were key discussion topics.
7. Service items available from the General Service Office made known to all Committee members and General Service Representatives.
8. Service assistance offered to all Loners, Groups, Inter-groups, Clubs, Institutional and Hospital Groups and Committees. Groups encouraged to register with General Service Office.
9. A. A. Publishing Inc. literature made known to all members. Literature order blanks made available.
10. The Grapevine made available to all. Editorial comments and contributions encouraged. Subscriptions also recommended.
11. Provincial and State Area General Service Conferences held in many places for the first time during the past year with excellent results.
12. General Service Representatives reported many successful special group meetings on Unity and World A. A. Service.
13. Monthly news bulletins to groups in area used successfully by many Delegates.
14. Special letters and effort on General Service Office contributions.

No proposals were presented to the grass roots during the past year. Six "Conference Discussion Subjects" were received from Delegates for the 1958 Conference Agenda.

G. S. Board of Trustees

(Cal M., Secretary)

Most of the actions taken by the Board of Trustees since the 1957 Conference are covered in reports of the various Committees. Therefore, the Secretary of the Board illustrated how the Board functions in its relationship to the movement and to other Committees by citing two examples:

EXAMPLE A—(Requests for Directory) Following a number of requests, G. S. O. adopted a new procedure covering requests for copies of the A. A. World Directory from State Commissions and other public authorities. Henceforth, all such requests will be cleared with the local A. A. group or Central Office and the Delegate from the Area nearest to source of inquiry.

The action of the Board of Trustees in this case started with the initial requests which were submitted to the staff members of the General Service Office. These were discussed by the General Service Committee and passed on to the Policy Committee with a recommendation. The Policy Committee then passed this matter on to the Board of Trustees with their recommendation. The Trustees recommended that individual requests be referred to the local A. A. group or Central Office and the Delegate in the Area involved.

EXAMPLE B—(Investment Committee) An A. A. member suggested that perhaps in consideration of potential inflation some of A. A.'s funds, which are now in savings banks, might be wisely invested for the movement by experts. This suggestion went to the Finance and Budgetary Committee. The Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended to the Board of

Trustees that a special investment Committee composed of prominent bankers (one alcoholic and two non-A. A. members) study this suggestion and, as a Subcommittee, give their recommendation to the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

This recommendation involved the withdrawal of A. A. funds from Savings Banks, establishment of a custodian account with the Trust Department of the Chase Manhattan Bank and purchases of the following securities to be held in trust: \$75,000 U. S. Treasury notes due August 1, 1961—yielding 2.88%; \$75,000 U. S. Treasury 90-day notes—yielding 2.59%. The Investment Committee also recommended that they felt it would be wise, in consideration of potential inflation, if some of the money were invested in equities as a "hedge." The Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended to the Board of Trustees that the Investment Committee be given authority to invest some percentage of the Reserve Fund in common stocks and convertible bonds.

The Board of Trustees after carefully discussing this matter at great length decided to allow the Investment Committee to invest up to 15% of invested capital in stocks and/or convertible bonds.

Thus a suggestion by an A. A. member first went to the Finance and Budgetary Committee which in turn set up a Subcommittee on Investments to study this special matter. Their recommendations were approved by the Finance and Budgetary Committee which in turn were approved by the Board of Trustees.

General Service Office Operations

(Hank G., Chairman, G. S. Committee)

Continuing increased demand for G. S. O. facilities is reflected in the following tabulations for 1957: (In nearly all cases the totals are higher than for the preceding year.)

INCOMING MAIL ITEMS	40,038
(Inquiries, Group Communications, Contributions, etc.)	
OUTGOING MAIL ITEMS	151,760
(Including Monthly Bulletins—9,500 per month)	
PACKAGES WRAPPED AND SHIPPED	25,274
(41,202 books, 610,159 pamphlets, 123 record sets, 199,729 wallet cards)	

The Accounting Department processed 10,006 orders for books, pamphlets, etc., and handled 7,033 contribution remittances.

Distribution of Books, Pamphlets and Miscellaneous Items in 1957

BOOKS	
Alcoholics Anonymous (Old Edition)	247
Alcoholics Anonymous (Revised Edition)	21,318
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions	7,735
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	11,902
Total Books Shipped	41,202

PAMPHLETS

This is A. A.	80,045
A. A.—44 Questions and Answers	70,911
Is A. A. for You?	88,173
Young People and A. A.	29,520
A. A. for the Woman	29,701

A. A. Tradition—How It Developed	19,262
Sponsorship	23,933
Alcoholism the Illness	39,304
The Alcoholic Husband	40,184
The Alcoholic Wife	28,710
The Alcoholic Employee	15,359
A. A. and the Medical Profession	26,164
Sedatives and the Alcoholic	27,870
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	33,466
Fortune Reprint	24,497
Good Housekeeping Reprint	25,670
The Third Legacy Manual	2,389
Foreign Translations	5,001

Total Pamphlets Shipped 610,159

MISCELLANEOUS

Wallet Cards	199,729
Parchment Scrolls	721
Lasker Award Replicas	18
Books — "A. A. — Spanish"	111
RECORDS	
Milestones Ahead	40
A. A.'s Three Legacies	47
A. A.'s Traditions	36

Total Record Sets Shipped 123

Twenty-nine persons are employed at Headquarters, in the following categories: A. A. Staff (7); Stenographic, filing, telephone and reception (11); Bookkeeping (4) and Shipping (7).

G. S. O. Policy Committee

(Icky S., Chairman)

Now in its second year, the Policy Committee has demonstrated its value as a clearinghouse for discussion and review of matters to be referred to the General Service Board for subsequent action. The contribution of Area Trustees on the Committee in reflecting local A. A. developments, trends and opinions has been a key factor in the Committee's deliberations.

Recommendations forwarded to the General Service Board during the past year included the following:

1. That A. A. Publishing, Inc. act on all proposals pertaining to foreign language editions of the book "Alcoholics Anonymous," declining foreign government subsidy for translating purposes.
2. That the Handbook section be deleted from the "Handbook and Directory" and adapted for incorporation in the pamphlet linking individuals to A. A. as a whole, recommended by the Conference. This matter was also communicated to the Conference Literature Committee.
3. That listing in the 1958 Directory be based upon the following qualification: "Traditionally any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A. A. group, provided that, as a group, they are

self-supporting and have no outside affiliation". The General Service Office will continue to assemble pertinent information regarding other groups, which can be made available upon inquiry.

4. That, as a matter of policy in reference to the revision of the Sedatives pamphlet, opinions on tranquilizers be secured from more doctors, psychiatrists, and psychologists, and the first draft of the revision of Sedatives and the Alcoholic be circulated to a list of such professional persons for comments and suggestions. (The draft would then be re-done and distributed to the Board of Trustees, the Conference Literature Committee, the Directors of A. A. Publishing, Inc. and the General Service Staff for approval before final distribution.)
5. That the Board recognize the potential value of a 25th Anniversary Convention and that, should the Conference vote for such a Convention, the Conference should take action regarding the site, designation of responsibility for programming, public relations and underwriting Convention cost. It was further suggested there be agreement within the host state or area as to the precise Convention site.

Public Information Committee

(Herb M., Chairman)

As a subcommittee of the Policy Committee, the Public Information Committee is an advisory committee. Its recommendations, when approved by the Policy Committee and the Trustees, are carried out as Service Office activities. The Committee feels it important that, in all public relations matters which it considers, the traditional A. A. policy of attraction rather than promotion be adhered to. The Committee held quarterly meetings prior to Policy Committee meetings and made the following recommendations.

1. That the "A. A. Fact" be up-dated, and that our policy of sending letters indicating its availability to editors and others in the communications media, be continued, including mailings to one thousand medical writers. Further, that the "Fact File" itself be sent directly to the Continuity Clearance Department of each major network, and to the Motion Picture Producers and Distributors of America office.
2. That, in connection with publication of Bill's book, "A. A. Comes of Age", we augment Harper's review list, and that no aggressive radio or television publicity efforts for the book be made.
3. That the Television Pattern Script be revised with further information as to ways in which anonymity can be preserved in this medium, and that these scripts suggest that a short statement be made preceding any telecast

show, as to why anonymity of the A. A. member is being protected.

4. That, if possible, Bill should make a talk before some medical association so that this can be incorporated in an up-dated pamphlet which would be of value to members of the medical profession. ("Alcoholism the Illness" includes talks dating from the Nineteen-Forties.)
5. That in reference to cancellation of the NBC contract for a television show, leaving A.A. in ownership of the "story treatment," only individual contacts be pursued and that there be no "shopping around" of the "story treatment."
6. That information about the "A. A. Fact File" be sent to the Medical and Chaplain Corps of the Air Force, Army and Navy and others in the Armed Forces in whose hands information about A. A. might be helpful.
7. That letters written in reference to anonymity be reviewed by Mr. Bernard Smith's law office.
8. That the Literature Committee prepare a leaflet based on excerpts from the "Fact File" for use in connection with showings of our display at professional meetings.
9. That we continue with our policy that the display be shown only at national professional meetings.
10. That the Policy Committee explore with the Conference methods for determining accurate membership figures.

Public Relations Activities

(Eve M.)

Movement-wide public relations for A.A. is primarily the interpreting of our traditions at the public level. Tradition Six, "non endorsement," Eleven, "attraction not promotion," and Twelve, "personal anonymity at the public level," are the keys to our relations with all publics and communications media.

Execution of recommendations by the Public Information Committee resulted as follows during 1957.

1. "A. A. Fact File": Letter mailings continued to 131 science writers, and 147 religious editors, with a 50% return with requests for the Fact File. A mailing to 1,000 medical writers will be made shortly.
2. Fact Files were sent to the Motion Picture Producers and Distributors of America office and the three major radio and television networks. Fact Files were also sent to the Medical and Chaplain Corps of the Air Force, Army and Navy, and to the Library of Congress, upon request. The TV Pattern Script has been revised with additional information in reference to anonymity. The Background Editorial Material has been sent to approximately 280 groups.
3. The professional exhibit was shown last year at meetings of National Conference on Social Welfare, the American Hospital Association and the American Academy of General Practice. It is to be shown in '58 at meetings of the American Tuberculosis Association, the American Nurses Association, the American Medical Association, and the American Correctional Congress. Volunteer committees are being asked to cover each meeting.
4. Contact has been made with a top producer at the Columbia Broadcasting System who has expressed interest in a television story treatment featuring Alcoholics Anonymous.

5. All correspondence pertaining to deliberate anonymity breaks is being reviewed by Mr. Bernard Smith's law office.

6. The leaflet for distribution at professional meetings has been completed.

Prints of the Loretta Young film loaned us by Procter & Gamble continue to be routed by G. S. O. Since August, 1956, the film has been distributed to 96 A.A. groups, 23 prisons, 14 hospitals, 6 State Commissions on Alcoholism, 1 railroad (personnel and medical section) and 1 department of health. It has been sent to 6 overseas areas and has been routed through the Montreal Service Office to approximately 60 groups in Canada. A backlog of requests remains.

As a result of interviews with Staff members, articles appeared in a national Brazilian newspaper and in a Spanish magazine distributed in the United States.

Newspaper clippings in reference to a motion picture entitled "No Greater Power" seemed to indicate that this was to be about Bill and A. A. Letters were written to the producer and we have been assured that there is no mention of A. A. or Bill in this film. Letters were also written to the producer's publicity department questioning the use of A. A. references in publicity releases.

Charles Scribner's Sons, publishers, consulted with the Office before their publication of the novel "The Twelfth Step," written by an A. A. member. Proofs were submitted to us and several G. S. O. suggestions were followed. Scribner's adhered to our Tradition of anonymity in all promotion of the book. (The author wrote under a pseudonym.)

There were fewer anonymity breaks during 1957. Correspondence indicates that the majority of members feel that our Tradition of anonymity at the public level is vital for A. A.'s unity and survival.

Foreign Relations - A. A. Overseas

(Lyb S.)

A. A. continues to grow and unify overseas. Last year was notable for many public meetings and A. A. Conventions. Local Service Committees and Offices expanded and strengthened. G. S. O. received many requests for permission to reprint A. A. Publishing, Inc. literature. Here are some highlights of A. A. development overseas.

SYDNEY, AUSTRALIA: March 27, 1957, the first public A. A. meeting was held in Sydney. Attendance 2,450—Overflow of 1,000 stood on steps outside hall and listened to the meeting over a public address system.

DUBLIN, IRELAND: March 8 - 9, 1958. First "All-Ireland" Convention.

DUNBLANE, SCOTLAND: April 5 - 7, 1958. Second Annual A. A. Convention.

CHELTHENHAM, ENGLAND: March 22 - 23, 1958. Third Annual A. A. Convention for England & Wales.

PORT ELIZABETH, SOUTH AFRICA: April 4 - 8, 1958. Annual South African Convention. Open to all races.

WEISBADEN, GERMANY: August 31 - September 1, 1957. Fifth Annual European Round-Up.

OSLO, NORWAY: May, 1957. Tenth Anniversary Conference of A. A. in Norway. 51 Groups reported "from Kirkenes in the North to Kristiansand in the South".

Services Strengthened

Local Service Committees and Offices were strengthened in the following areas:

FRANKFURT, GERMANY: Intergroup Office opened in the basement of the Frankfurt subarea Chapel. Manned by volunteers; it maintains list of A. A. contacts in Europe, as well as information on groups in Germany.

SYDNEY, N. S. W., AUSTRALIA: Reorganized Intergroup. Increased staff to serve more than 50 new groups in New South Wales.

MELBOURNE, VICTORIA, AUSTRALIA: Moved Central Office to new quarters. Continues to use old office for group meeting place.

BRISBANE, QUEENSLAND, AUSTRALIA: New Central Service Office opened.

HELSINKI, FINLAND: Operating Service Office for all A. A. groups in Finland. Finnish translation of books "Alcoholics Anonymous" and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" and certain Conference-approved pamphlets, as well as a Finnish A. A. Journal are for sale. Permission granted to translate "A. A. Comes of Age" into Finnish.

OSLO, NORWAY: Operating Central Service Office to handle inquiries from individuals and services to A. A. groups in Norway. Distributes a Bulletin to A. A. Norwegian groups periodically; has Norwegian A. A. pamphlets and tape recordings for sale.

INDIA: In the past year, A. A. in India has spread from 1 group in New Delhi to 5 other cities. In three cities there are active groups; in the others lone members are trying to start groups.

Language Volunteers

Six volunteer A. A. members have given time and special talents to help the General Service Office overcome language barriers and understand A. A. activities in Denmark, Germany, Holland, Norway and Sweden. They also helped us set up Loner Sponsorship correspondence in French, German and Spanish, and have checked and revised pamphlet translations.

Literature Distribution

Permission to translate and distribute Conference-approved literature was granted to A. A. in new countries:

BRUSSELS, BELGIUM: Permission granted to translate, into French, Conference-approved pamphlets and the beginning of Chapter V of the A. A. book.

FRANKFURT, GERMANY: Permission granted to the Frankfurt Intergroup Committee to translate A. A. Publishing pamphlets into German. "This is A. A." and "A. A.—44 Questions and Answers" have been translated.

AMSTERDAM, HOLLAND: Permission granted to the Service Committee for A. A. in the Netherlands to translate Bill's story from the A. A. Book for inclusion in a Dutch pamphlet based on the experience of A. A. in Holland.

OSLO, NORWAY: Permission granted to the Klubben Group to translate and distribute, as a Christmas gift to groups in Norway, Bill's Story from the A. A. book.

PUERTO RICO: Permission granted to translate "A. A. Comes of Age" into Spanish.

BUENOS AIRES, ARGENTINA: Permission was granted to the Arthur Group to translate 14 Conference-approved pamphlets into Spanish.

DURBAN, NATAL, SOUTH AFRICA: Permission granted to A. A. member to translate the Twelve Steps from the Big Book into Zulu.

COPENHAGEN, DENMARK: Permission granted to translate "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions", and Conference-approved pamphlets.

HELSINKI, FINLAND: Permission granted to translate "A. A. Comes of Age".

The General Service Office has received Hungarian Translations of the Twelve Steps and the Serenity Prayer.

Thanks to the fine cooperation of the Dupont Company, we loaned to overseas groups a copy of the film "One Day At A Time". It was shown in Germany, England, Scotland, Ireland and South Africa, and is scheduled for France and Belgium this summer, before going to Australia and New Zealand. Approximately 2,000 A. A. members, their friends and families have attended screenings of this print to date.

A complimentary supply of Conference-approved pamphlets in English or, where appropriate, pamphlets in one of six other languages were sent to new A. A. groups and lone members. Material based upon past A. A. group experience, as well as A. A. public relations material, was distributed to English-speaking A. A.s with permission to translate any of the material suitable to their needs.

Sent to Russia

At the request of an Irish A. A. member who visited Moscow last summer, we sent pamphlets and the A. A. Book to a professor in Moscow, Russia. In answer to a letter from a Catholic priest we sent the A. A. Book and pamphlets to Poland.

A. A. Publishing, Inc., is negotiating with a Norwegian publishing company and soon hopes to have a basic A. A. book in Norwegian. This book will consist of the first 11 Chapters of the A. A. Book, plus several of the stories, material on Traditions from "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" and some material from "A. A. Comes of Age". The purpose of the proposed book is to transmit to alcoholics and non-alcoholic friends the A. A. experience of recovery, unity and service.

Visitors interested in overseas A. A., as well as letters to G. S. O., indicate the need for such a basic book in French, German, Danish, Swedish, Spanish, Portuguese and Dutch.

Institutional A. A. (Prisons & Hospitals)

(Ann M.)

290 Hospital Groups — Membership 6,500

325 Prison Groups — Membership 13,500

A recent survey of hospital and prison groups taken to determine their needs indicates that literature is first on the list and better cooperation from outside groups is second. Many groups indicated that special pamphlets directed to the hospitalized or inmate alcoholic would be helpful. The introductory pamphlets, "Is A.A. For You?", and "A.A.—44 Questions and Answers" were considered the most useful of the pamphlets distributed by A. A. Publishing. Of all A. A. literature, the *Grapevine* was considered most valuable by these groups.

About half the hospital groups who replied to the questionnaire found that "local" pamphlets were most in use. A conclusion that can be drawn from this is that after the initial supply of complimentary literature sent to a new hospital group is exhausted, many groups do not see our literature again. In the case of hospital groups where the patient turnover is so rapid, this means that newcomers to a group may not see any of our literature.

Several problems which have come to light in "hospital A. A." are:

1. The difficulty of maintaining the group structure as is done on the outside, due to rapid patient turnover or the illness of the patients.
2. The difficulty of securing members of the hospital staff who have the time and the interest to act as coordinators.
3. The difficulty, in large mental institutions, of finding escorts for the patients who are attending meetings. In many instances, if attendants are not available, patients cannot attend meetings.
4. The lack of funds to produce hospital publications similar to the prison publications.

The survey of both types of institutional groups poses the question of whether or not our material is adequate to meet their needs and seems to support the contention that special literature may be needed.

A problem that continues to pose a challenge is that of drug addicts and their relationship to inmate A. A. groups. Bill's article in the February *Grapevine* has helped to clarify this issue. To sum up the thinking from a number of informed sources on this question: any individual who is an alcoholic but who may also have had the problem of drug addiction is, of course, a member of A. A. if he says that he is; the individual who is not an alcoholic should not consider himself a member of A. A., and an inmate group that is composed of drug addicts who are not alcoholics is not an A. A. group. An effort is now being made by some groups which have been composed of both alcoholics and drug addicts to separate the two into A. A. groups and "NA" groups.

A new development in Institutional A. A. is the wish of several areas to include these groups in the Conference structure and to enable their GSRs to vote by proxy at Assembly meetings. This plan has already been put into effect in three areas and interest has been indicated by other areas.

Two articles on A. A. have appeared in the New York State Journal of Medicine and in Hospital Management as a result of requests received at G.S.O. "Patterns of Hospital Cooperation," which was prepared last year, has been in constant use and has been helpful to many A.A.s who are interested in establishing hospital groups in their areas. To supplement this, a G.S.O. brochure containing comments of Hospital Administrators is now also available.

A recent survey of prison administrators brought forth a warm response. Over a hundred comments received were, in the main, glowing testimonials to the value of A.A. in penal institutions.

Continued interest on the part of the National Tuberculosis Association has brought about a number of inquiries from TB hospital administrators and an exchange of experience among TB groups who have somewhat specialized problems.

An increasing number of institutional committees and sponsorship programs patterned after "Big Brothers of A.A." in Ohio indicates the continuing interest of A.A.s on the outside in this important work.

Literature Committee

(Cal M., Chairman)

Literature Committee assignments carried out during the past year included production of the monthly A. A. *Exchange Bulletin*, up-dating and revision of several existing pamphlets and folders, preparation of the 1957 Conference Report and the special "Conference Highlights" four-page digest for the groups, preparation of Interim Reports distributed to Conference personnel, and related projects.

Three items of special interest were produced. One is a new pamphlet, "Partners in A.A.," which was authorized by the 1957 Conference. Another is a revision of the "Sponsorship" pamphlet in question and answer format. The third is a leaflet, "A.A.—Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism," which is for distribution at conventions where the G.S.O. Public Information Exhibit is displayed.

In connection with the proposed "Oldtimers" pamphlet authorized by the 1957 Conference, all delegates were surveyed and asked for suggestions and case histories on "oldtimers." Only 12 replies were received from 5 states. The Committee feels that the material which was submitted is inadequate to warrant proceeding to publication and recommended that the

1958 Conference reconsider the advisability of publishing this pamphlet.

The Committee has received a suggestion from a number of prison groups and from non-alcoholics in prison work requesting a special pamphlet that might be available for jails and prisons. It has been suggested that the material for this pamphlet include success stories of former inmates that a prisoner could identify himself with. A further suggestion is that this pamphlet might be effective in comic booklet format.

The Committee has been working for some time on the very different assignment of revising the "Sedatives" pamphlet. Opinion on tranquilizers are being secured from doctors, psychiatrists and physiologists. When the first draft of "Sedatives and the Alcoholic" has been revised it will be circulated to a list of such professional persons for comments and suggestions. The draft will then be re-done and distributed to the Board of Trustees, the Conference Literature Committee, the Directors of A.A. Publishing Co. and the General Service Staff before final distribution.

The above activities are exclusive of Bill's continuing activities in the field of basic book literature for the movement.

Group Services, Records and Directory

(Anita R.)

The maintenance of reasonably effective contacts with the groups is improving, but is a big problem and not always solved successfully. In a further attempt to link the groups more effectively to the General Service Office and reduce the time and procedures used in record keeping, a very simple Group Information Card was used for the 1958 World Directory. Groups were asked to send one address which would be good for at least *one year*—the same address to be used for Directory listing and mailing purposes. It was suggested that P. O. Boxes or meeting places be used when practical. For the most part, co-operation was good.

In accordance with 1957 Conference approval, groups were inactivated automatically if General Service had had no contact with them during the past year via Directory Card, new registration, letter, order, contribution or listing by a Delegate, Committeeman or local Intergroup. More than 700 groups were inactivated and omitted from the 1958 Directory. A few of these have been replaced on the mailing list as a result of communications after the deadline. It is hoped that groups will become more aware of the importance of returning information cards promptly with up-to-date information.

'Bulletin' Helpful

The *A. A. Exchange Bulletin* was helpful as a means of explaining the new, simplified approach to the problem of getting information from the groups. Some groups responded and co-operated in obtaining P. O. boxes or permanent mailing addresses as the result of a Bulletin story.

Beginning with the September issue of the *A. A. Exchange Bulletin*, bulk mailings were sent to seven groups in each State and Province monthly, accompanied by a questionnaire to determine the interest of members in the *Bulletin*. In the first 385 replies received, 25 were not interested, 238 mildly interested and 112 very interested.

A few comments from questionnaires:

"Good idea but one needing additional publicity. Place our order for ten per month."

"It is interesting and sort of taken for granted. Keep at least one coming."

"Probably O. K. in large group but not in a small group. We are more interested in maintaining our little group than in A. A. as a whole or the operation thereof."

"I don't believe too much interest will be taken in the Bulletin. Hope it will not be discontinued."

Specific Problems

Each year many letters are received from Groups and Central Offices with specific problems. As the clearing house of accumulated A. A. world-wide experience, G. S. O. answers questions in terms of the experience of other groups and Central Offices that have faced and handled the same, or similar problems. Typical "problems:"

1. How do Intergroup Committees raise funds beyond contributions received from participating groups?
2. Should Al-Anon Groups be associated with a Central Service Office?
3. Should non-alcoholics be admitted to closed meetings?

Inquiries and Internationalists

(Jane F.)

Inquiries

The variety and diversity of the inquiries points up both the growing awareness of alcoholism as a disease and the spreading knowledge that there is help to be had. An isolated alcoholic reads a column in the *Kansas City Star*. The Department of the Navy in Washington needs special information. Nurses, students, researchers—doctors, employers, clergymen—they all write, asking for facts about the Fellowship of A. A. in the hope our answer may throw some light on the problem of alcoholism.

Less frequently, pleas come from troubled families and from individual alcoholics who look to us for a solution to an intolerable situation.

Share Fellowship

The alcoholic who cries 'please help me' is put in touch immediately with the nearest group or Loner in the area. If no close contact exists, he or she is invited to register with us as a Loner and share in our Fellowship by mail.

Each answer to an inquiry is an attempt to help—directly or indirectly—those who still suffer.

Internationalists

Internationalists stop in every port in the free world. Through their letters, we visit strange cities—walk exotic streets—see curious sights. We live through winter storms in the North Atlantic—bask in the Mediterranean Spring—steam through the burning heat of summer in the Persian Gulf.

Whatever the backdrop—whatever the language of the street cries outside the window—the letters tell of peace and a new awareness of life—and, whatever the postmark—of the comforting similarity of A. A. whether in Akron or Afghanistan, Topeka or Timbuctu.

Shuttling the sea lanes of the globe, Internationalists carry the message from Hamburg, from Hong Kong, from busy centers of commerce to sleepy jungle ports. They spread the hope of recovery. Through them, new members register with us. The new Internationalist is supplied with complimentary literature, a World Directory—and a special listing of his fellow Internationalists. Monthly he receives the *A. A. Exchange Bulletin*, and correspondence from time to time. A. A. goes to the world, around the world—through its recovering members.

The great need is to tell the Fellowship as a whole of the existence of this service to Internationalists.

G. S. B. Treasurer

Operations of A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies resulted in a net loss of \$1,629 in 1957 as compared with net income of \$8,717 in 1956.

A.A. Publishing, Inc. earned \$42,196, of which \$25,000 was paid in dividends to the General Fund.

The A.A. Grapevine operations resulted in a loss of \$13,159.

Group Contributions in 1957 were \$169,042 as compared with \$152,839 collected in 1956 and \$13,240 transferred from 1955 to help meet the cost of the 1956 Conference. The 1957 contributions failed by \$14,918 to meet office and Conference expenses.

The above figures are exclusive of additions to the Reserve Fund of \$21,867, of which \$14,918 was transferred to the Group Fund to make up the deficit in contributions.

"Exhibit A" (page 16) shows the combined income and expenses of A.A.'s service agencies for the years 1957 and 1956.

"Exhibit B" (page 17) shows the combined assets, liabilities and net worth of the agencies as of December 31, 1957 and 1956.

G. S. B. Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use must be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CONTRIBUTION FUND, established in 1941 receives contributions from A.A. Groups and members which may be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office and the costs of the General Service Conference.

The GENERAL FUND is comprised of those assets not included in either of the above Funds and may be used for any of the purposes for which the General Service Board of A.A., Inc. was incorporated.

Miami in 1956?

The Miami Area extended a formal invitation to hold an International A. A. Convention in Miami in 1956.

1957 Group Contributions

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE FUND

(United States Groups)

STATE	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita.
Alabama	34	30	88%	\$ 1,499	898	\$1.67
Arizona	41	32	78	1,276	592	2.16
Arkansas	51	35	69	1,143	969	1.18
California	627	435	69	23,357	14,502	1.61
Colorado	54	36	67	2,034	1,133	1.80
Connecticut	59	46	78	2,380	1,347	1.77
Delaware	14	9	64	455	320	1.42
Dist. of Columbia	20	13	65	764	423	1.81
Florida	148	105	71	5,047	3,168	1.59
Georgia	54	31	57	1,245	1,160	1.07
Idaho	25	16	64	612	307	1.99
Illinois	379	338	89	5,041	5,667	.89
Indiana	121	80	66	2,731	1,705	1.60
Iowa	68	46	68	2,145	1,766	1.21
Kansas	67	48	72	2,066	1,343	1.54
Kentucky	50	39	78	2,232	662	3.37
Louisiana	55	29	53	1,300	1,073	1.21
Maine	38	25	66	655	454	1.44
Maryland	66	49	74	1,930	1,286	1.50
Massachusetts	147	87	59	4,470	2,961	1.51
Michigan	224	172	77	8,546	4,321	1.98
Minnesota	116	84	72	3,606	2,940	1.23
Mississippi	28	20	72	1,417	570	2.49
Missouri	104	92	88	5,547	2,079	2.67
Montana	32	17	53	477	456	1.05
Nebraska	36	30	73	736	465	1.58
Nevada	17	12	71	629	425	1.48
New Hampshire	19	12	63	395	273	1.45
New Jersey	158	103	65	4,524	2,581	1.75
New Mexico	24	18	75	670	414	1.62
New York	324	220	68	11,321	7,282	1.55
North Carolina	107	69	64	3,450	2,192	1.57
North Dakota	36	18	50	625	491	1.27
Ohio	327	188	58	8,840	7,999	1.11
Oklahoma	55	45	82	3,382	1,069	3.16
Oregon	54	35	65	1,180	677	1.74
Pennsylvania	209	155	75	5,968	3,442	1.73
Rhode Island	17	13	77	271	239	1.14
South Carolina	52	36	69	1,121	848	1.32
South Dakota	32	23	72	835	622	1.34
Tennessee	34	23	68	1,280	720	1.78
Texas	232	168	73	7,834	4,985	1.57
Utah	37	27	73	770	569	1.35
Vermont	21	18	86	720	293	2.46
Virginia	77	57	74	2,914	1,878	1.55
Washington	99	69	70	2,828	1,625	1.74
West Virginia	36	26	72	946	523	1.81
Wisconsin	117	91	78	3,448	1,862	1.76
Wyoming	13	12	92	461	170	2.71
Total for U. S. A.	4,755	3,382	71%	\$147,134	93,746	\$1.57

(Canadian Group and Other Contributions on Next Page)

NOTES ON TRUSTEES

Delegates to the Eighth General Service Conference were fortunate in being able to meet and hear seven of the eight non-alcoholic Trustees of the General Service Board. Only Mr. L. Ivan Underwood was unable to be present due to absence from New York on business.

Mr. Leonard Harrison, chairman of the Board, spoke briefly at the opening dinner Wednesday evening. He described his pleasure in being able to visit A.A. service offices in various parts of the country during his travels on special assignments in the field of social welfare.

Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, son of one of America's distinguished presidents, is the treasurer of the General Service Board. He introduced the presentation of G.S.O. financial data during the Conference and also attended other Conference sessions.

Mr. Frank Gulden, noted for his interest in philanthropic activities as well as for his position in the business world, also addressed the Delegates and their spouses Wednesday evening. Mr. Gulden commented on the spiritual qualities in the A.A. program and delivered a brief invocation.

Dr. John L. Norris, Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company, spoke to the Conference twice. He discussed the increased interest in "A.A. therapy" on the part of industrial medical directors and, at Sunday's closing session, presented a brief but moving talk on spiritual factors in the growth of the movement. Dr. Norris is vice chairman of the board.

Professor Harrison Trice of Cornell, addressing one of the main sessions of the Conference, reminded the Delegates that A.A. "has quite an impact on medicine, on psychology, on psychiatry—an impact that is quiet but far-reaching."

Finally, the movement will long remember Mr. Bernard B. Smith's contribution to the Eighth General Service Conference when he proposed the "ratio of Trustees" formula described on page four of this report. One of A.A.'s oldest non-alcoholic friends, Mr. Smith has twice been chairman of the Board.

One of the most impressive moments of the Conference occurred when Jim O., Washington State Delegate, described the kind of interest in Conference activity that is developing in his State. Jim noted that a mechanic, his wife and their eight children had traveled 250 miles across the State to attend a recent Area Assembly.

1957 Group Contributions

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE FUND

(Canadian Groups)

PROVINCE	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita.
Alberta	61	32	52%	\$ 1,069	723	\$1.48
New Brunswick	16	12	75	506	338	1.50
Prince Edward I.	4	3	75	97	120	.81
Newfoundland	5	2	40	64	88	.74
Nova Scotia	37	23	62	992	584	1.70
British Columbia	119	78	66	4,186	1,748	2.40
Manitoba	28	23	82	1,594	699	2.28
Ontario	235	153	65	6,681	3,752	1.78
Quebec	121	47	39	1,346	1,820	.74
Saskatchewan	51	34	67	1,203	621	1.94
Yukon Territory	1	0	0	0	37	0
Northwest Territories	2	1	50	12	18	.69
Total for Canada	680	408	60%	\$ 17,756	10,548	1.68
Total U.S.A. & Canada	5,435	3,790	70%	\$164,891	104,294	\$1.58

(Other Contributions)

33 Groups in U. S. Territories.....	\$1,270
743 Groups outside U. S. A., Canada and U. S. Territories.....	1,731
290 Hospital Groups.....	360
325 Prison Groups.....	403
150 Internationalists	407

1958 General Service Budget

The budget for 1958 operations of General Service Office, exclusive of the A. A. Grapevine:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, GROSS PROFIT,
AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	Receipts	Expenses	Net Income	Net (Deficit)
General Service Office (Contributions)	\$185,000	\$199,100 *		(\$14,100)
A.A. Publishing, Inc. (Gross Profit)	116,275 **	80,750	35,525	
General Service Board		20,650		(20,650)
TOTALS	\$301,275	\$300,500	\$35,525	(\$34,750)

NET ESTIMATED INCOME \$775 ***

* Including Cost of General Service Conference _____ \$20,000

** Based Upon Sales of _____ 20,000 books "Alcoholics Anonymous"
(Total income less 7,500 books "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
printing & royalty exp.) 10,000 books "A.A. Comes of Age"
Averaged—Pamphlets & Miscellaneous

*** Exclusive of Reserve Fund Appreciation of _____ \$16,875
(from Book Discounts and Interest)

It should be noted that regardless of rising costs and expanded activity, the estimated expenses of GSO have increased by only \$15,140 over the annual cost of such services during 1957.

Contributions of \$185,000 might be expected during 1958, representing about \$16,000 in excess of the total received in 1957. Each year over the past five years, as the need for services becomes more widely known, contributions have increased annually.

Combined Income Statement

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. Alcoholics Anonymous Publishing, Inc.
The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

	YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1957					YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1956				
	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD GENERAL	OFFICE	A.A. PUBLISHING	A.A. GRAPEVINE	TOTAL	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD GENERAL	OFFICE	A.A. PUBLISHING	A.A. GRAPEVINE	TOTAL
WE RECEIVED FROM:										
Book Sales										
Alcoholics Anonymous			\$ 72,854		\$72,854			\$ 79,841		\$ 79,841
12 Steps & 12 Traditions			17,212		17,212			15,749		15,749
AA Comes of Age			34,212		34,212					
Pamphlets & Other Sales			74,270		74,270					
Grapevine Income				\$124,341	124,341			77,124		77,124
Total Sales					322,889				\$108,952	108,952
Group Contributions		\$169,042			169,042		\$166,079			281,666
TOTAL INCOME		<u>169,042</u>	<u>198,548</u>	<u>124,341</u>	<u>491,931</u>		<u>166,079</u>	<u>172,714</u>	<u>108,952</u>	<u>447,745</u>
WE SPENT FOR:										
Cost of Products Sold			54,182	49,349	103,531			50,716	44,465	95,181
Royalties on Books			24,213		24,213			18,444		18,444
Shipping and Mailing			13,724	16,036	29,760			12,855	11,673	24,528
Salaries		94,565	30,154	45,645	170,364		81,794	26,428	33,546	141,768
Public Relations & Writers			6,000		6,000	\$ 708	2,901	3,965		7,574
Legal & Accounting	\$ 3,471		3,026	2,775	9,272	2,579		3,082	1,200	6,861
Honorarium	2,000				2,000	2,000				2,000
Rent		14,853	5,562	3,928	24,343	1,200	12,425	5,552	2,400	21,577
Printing	2,102	24,865			26,967	1,714	20,099			21,813
Stationery & Office Supplies		6,302		2,955	9,257		3,853		5,207	9,060
Telephone & Telegraph		2,947		817	3,764		2,777		723	3,500
New Equipment or Depreciation		4,909	340	940	6,189		2,075	2,228	760	5,063
Other Office Expenses	64	6,189	983	3,581	10,817	388	5,680	899	5,347	12,314
Insurance	374	3,269		982	4,625	351	1,579			1,930
Taxes		4,076	500	1,653	6,229		2,821	485	1,246	4,552
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	5,327	1,419		648	7,394	5,025	1,366		908	7,299
Promotion			883	7,310	8,193				13,328	13,328
Editing & Research			12,870		12,870			12,596		12,596
Bedford Hills Expense			3,915		3,915			3,812		3,812
General Service Conference		20,566		881	21,477		20,697			20,697
Public Information Committee	832				832	2,016				2,016
Television Program	1,578				1,578	2,715				2,715
TOTAL COSTS & EXPENSES	<u>15,748</u>	<u>183,960</u>	<u>156,352</u>	<u>137,500</u>	<u>493,560</u>	<u>18,696</u>	<u>158,067</u>	<u>141,062</u>	<u>120,803</u>	<u>438,628</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXP)—EXH. B	(15,748)	(14,918)	<u>42,196</u>	<u>(13,159)</u>	<u>(1,629)</u>	(18,696)	<u>8,012</u>	<u>31,652</u>	<u>(11,851)</u>	<u>9,117</u>
Dividend Rec'd AA Pub., Inc.	25,000					20,000				
Transferred from Reserve Fund		14,918								
Net Income, after Transfers	<u>9,252</u>	<u>None</u>				<u>1,304</u>				

() Denote red figures

See Note A on Exhibit B for Changes in RESERVE FUND

Combined Balance Sheet

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. Alcoholics Anonymous Publishing, Inc.
The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

	DECEMBER 31, 1957					DECEMBER 31, 1956				
	GENERAL SERVICE BOARD		A.A.	A.A.		GENERAL SERVICE BOARD		A.A.	A.A.	
	GENERAL	OFFICE	PUBLISHING	GRAPEVINE	TOTAL	GENERAL	OFFICE	PUBLISHING	GRAPEVINE	TOTAL
WHAT WE OWNED:										
Cash, Except Reserve Fund	\$27,650	\$15,380	\$12,603	\$12,412	\$68,045	\$13,460	\$31,211	\$13,979	\$28,094	\$86,744
Accounts Receivable			5,328	3,139	8,467			4,125	1,927	6,052
Inventories			66,300		66,300			48,100		48,100
Advance Royalties			2,186		2,186			3,162		3,162
Other Prepaid Expenses	1,221	64	2,187	7,840	11,312	1,161		2,501	7,694	11,356
Furniture & Equipment (net)			1	4,348	4,349			1	3,884	3,885
RESERVE FUND—Cash	168,177		1,254		169,431	146,762		802		147,564
Inter-Company Accounts:										
Advances	12,824	14,918	18,740		Note C	12,372		14,306		Note C
Less Reserve for Loss	(11,570)				Note B	(11,570)				Note D
Investments	501				Note E	501				Note E
TOTAL ASSETS	<u>198,803</u>	<u>30,362</u>	<u>108,599</u>	<u>27,739</u>	<u>330,090</u>	<u>162,686</u>	<u>31,211</u>	<u>86,976</u>	<u>41,599</u>	<u>306,863</u>
DEDUCT: WHAT WE OWED										
Accounts & Accruals Payable	24		5,745	5,958	11,727	34		1,770	9,881	11,685
Deferred Subscription Income				47,100	47,100				44,153	44,153
Inter-Company Accounts:										
Advances	14,925	18,457	1,254	11,845	Note C		14,306	802	11,570	Note C
Capital Stock			500	1	Note E			500	1	Note E
TOTAL LIABILITIES	<u>14,949</u>	<u>18,457</u>	<u>7,499</u>	<u>64,904</u>	<u>58,827</u>	<u>34</u>	<u>14,306</u>	<u>3,072</u>	<u>65,605</u>	<u>55,838</u>
NET WORTH	<u>183,854</u>	<u>11,905</u>	<u>101,100</u>	<u>(37,165)</u>	<u>271,263</u>	<u>162,652</u>	<u>16,905</u>	<u>83,904</u>	<u>(24,006)</u>	<u>251,025</u>
NET WORTH—Comprised of:										
Accumulated Income										
Balance Jan. 1 less RES. FUND	15,089	16,905	83,904	(24,006)	91,891	45,354	(11,107)	72,252	(12,155)	94,344
Income (Expense) for year Exh. A	(15,748)	(14,918)	42,196	(13,159)	(1,629)	(18,696)	8,012	31,652	(11,851)	9,117
Inter-Company Transfers										
Adjustment of Advances—Note B	5,000	(5,000)			11,570	(31,570)	20,000			Note D
Dividends & Other	25,000	14,918	(25,000)		14,918	20,000		(20,000)		
RESERVE FUND—Note A	154,513				154,513	147,564				147,564
Balance, Dec. 31, as above	<u>183,854</u>	<u>11,905</u>	<u>101,100</u>	<u>(37,165)</u>	<u>271,263</u>	<u>162,652</u>	<u>16,905</u>	<u>83,904</u>	<u>(24,006)</u>	<u>251,025</u>
NOTE A—RESERVE FUND	<u>1957</u>	<u>1956</u>								
Balance, Beginning of Period	147,564	131,203								
Book Discounts Donated	17,079	12,316								
Interest on Savings Accounts	4,788	4,045								
	<u>169,431</u>	<u>147,564</u>								
Trans. to Group Cont. Fund	14,918									
Balance, End of Period	<u>154,513</u>	<u>147,564</u>								

NOTE B—In 1956 a reserve of \$11,570 was provided for possible loss on advances made to The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. in the years 1947-50. The unpaid balance of \$20,000 of advances to make up deficits in Group Contributions in the years 1949 and 1950 was removed from these statements in 1956. Repayment of \$5,000 on account of this balance was made in 1957. Any excess of contributions over expenses of the Group Contribution Fund in future years will be transferred to the Reserve Fund in repayment of this balance of \$15,000 and the advance of \$14,918 to make up the 1957 deficit in Group Contributions.

NOTES C, D and E—Elimination of offsetting intercompany balances.

Suggested Share of the Budget

Based on an estimated budget of \$200,000 and using the 1957 membership as a factor, the suggested share of each state and province for the year 1958 is apportioned in the following

STATE	1957 MEMBERSHIP	PER CAPITA 1958 BUDGET	STATE & PROVINCE SHARE
Alabama	898	\$1.917	\$ 1,730
Arizona	592	"	1,135
Arkansas	969	"	1,858
California	14,502	"	27,822
Colorado	1,133	"	2,172
Connecticut	1,347	"	2,582
Delaware	320	"	614
District of Columbia	423	"	811
Florida	3,168	"	6,070
Georgia	1,160	"	2,222
Idaho	307	"	589
Illinois	5,667	"	10,859
Indiana	1,705	"	3,267
Iowa	1,766	"	3,383
Kansas	1,343	"	2,574
Kentucky	662	"	1,269
Louisiana	1,073	"	2,056
Maine	454	"	870
Maryland	1,286	"	2,464
Massachusetts	2,961	"	5,673
Michigan	4,321	"	8,280
Minnesota	2,940	"	5,634
Mississippi	570	"	1,091
Missouri	2,079	"	3,984
Montana	456	"	874
Nebraska	465	"	892
Nevada	425	"	815
New Hampshire	273	"	524
New Jersey	2,581	"	4,946
New Mexico	414	"	794
New York	7,282	"	13,989
North Carolina	2,192	"	4,201
North Dakota	491	"	942
Ohio	7,999	"	15,327
Oklahoma	1,069	"	2,049

schedule. For budget purposes, only groups in in the United States and Canada have been estimated.
U. S. A.

STATE	1957 MEMBERSHIP	PER CAPITA 1958 BUDGET	STATE & PROVINCE SHARE
Oregon	677	\$1.917	\$ 1,297
Pennsylvania	3,442	"	6,596
Rhode Island	239	"	457
South Carolina	848	"	1,626
South Dakota	622	"	1,192
Tennessee	720	"	1,380
Texas	4,985	"	9,609
Utah	569	"	1,090
Vermont	293	"	561
Virginia	1,878	"	3,600
Washington	1,625	"	3,114
West Virginia	523	"	1,002
Wisconsin	1,862	"	3,569
Wyoming	170	"	325
TOTAL FOR U. S. A.	93,746	\$1.917	\$179,780

CANADA	1957 MEMBERSHIP	PER CAPITA 1958 BUDGET	STATE & PROVINCE SHARE
Northwest Terr.	18	\$1.917	\$ 35
Alberta	723	"	1,385
British Columbia	1,748	"	3,351
Manitoba	699	"	1,341
New Brunswick	338	"	649
Newfoundland	88	"	171
Nova Scotia	584	"	1,120
Ontario	3,752	"	7,190
Prince Edward Isle	120	"	230
Quebec	1,820	"	3,487
Saskatchewan	621	"	1,190
Yukon Territory	37	"	71
TOTAL FOR CANADA	10,548	\$1.917	\$ 20,220
TOTAL FOR U.S.A. & CANADA	104,294	\$1.917	\$200,000

Bill's Statement on His Finances

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board:

Dear Archie:

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership.

Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audit. This practice will of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amounts I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,
Bill

(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P. S. I hope that the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

'General Service Conference Committees'

The importance of consistent and continuing effort to develop increased understanding of A.A.'s world services at the Area level was emphasized by the five Delegates who participated in a special workshop on "General Service Conference Committees." The presentation was moderated by Howard B. (Northeastern Ohio). Principal speakers included Ed McN. (Central N. Y.), Jim O. (Washington State), Jim H. (Alabama) and Niles D. (Iowa).

Digests of the presentation follow:

IOWA

The State is divided into eleven Areas and the objective is to link all the groups in an Area to an established "mother" group serving not more than eight other groups. (Formerly the State had had only four Areas.)

Monthly or quarterly meetings of Area Committeemen are scheduled. The duties and responsibilities of the State Chairman and Delegate are clearly separated.

The State Committee has cooperated in the development of a program for alcoholics in a leading State mental institution. This has had the effect of strengthening institutional A.A. in the State.

CENTRAL N. Y. STATE

Since 1956 all members in the Area have had a voice in selection of a Delegate, who may or may not be a member of the Area Committee. (The present Delegate is not.)

At one time the seven-member Area Committee rotated meetings from town to town but did not admit local members. It is now realized that this was a mistake and that "the Conference is for all members."

Present procedure calls for open meetings the second Sunday of each month, with all General Service Representatives in the Area, and other interested alcoholics, invited to attend. Area serves 83 groups of whom approximately 65 are active in Conference affairs. The monthly meetings attract from 50 to 135 persons, with an average of 50 G. S. R.s, providing direct linkage to the groups. The Area Committee itself has been enlarged to 13 members but it is felt that the G. S. R.s, rather than the Committeemen, are the key people in getting the Third Legacy story to the groups.

The Area meetings are two-hour sessions. The first hour is devoted exclusively to Conference activities, with the Delegate on hand to describe and answer questions about services provided by G. S. O. The second hour is a regular A.A. open meeting, usually featuring a guest speaker.

Groups in the Area are asked to select G. S. R.s by mid-September in Assembly years. About October 1, the G. S. R.s meet and select the Area Committee, who elect officers and a Delegate.

One result of the procedures in this Area is that the G. S. R.s get to know each other and become familiar with the work of active members who may not be group representatives.

WASHINGTON STATE

Area has eleven Districts with 95 groups and an estimated 2,180 members. The first Delegate in 1951 formed a special team of fellow-members in Seattle who began to carry the Third Legacy message to nearly every group in the State.

Delegate and State Chairman divide duties. Delegate: (1) assists groups and local committees; (2) explains the Third

Legacy, (3) tries to help new groups or groups in some difficulty, (4) counsels regarding the Conference structure and publicity and (5) handles inquiries and comments on anonymity "breaks." The Delegate also calls meetings of the Area Committee although this can also be done by a majority of Committee members.

State Chairman presides at Committee meetings, is responsible for records and helps to schedule District meetings.

Washington is one State which permits participation (by proxy) of institutional groups in the Conference structure. The Delegates stressed the importance of using "great diplomacy" in introducing the proxy idea in prisons since not all correctional officials are equally receptive to the idea. Officials in Washington State have been most cooperative.

All "frills" are eliminated at Area Assemblies: no registration fees, no banquets, no dances, low-cost hotel accommodations. Policy has proved successful in attracting Area participation.

ALABAMA

Tangible evidence of increased Area participation (after "a slow start") was noted: (1) Per capita contributions increased from \$1.14 in 1956 to \$1.67 in 1957; (2) The percentage of groups contributing increased from 41% to 88%; (3) Dollar contributions were 25% higher in 1957.

Financing of Area Conference activity has been placed on a sounder basis, designed to yield a maximum of \$450 yearly. The retiring Delegate automatically becomes State Chairman, to capitalize his G. S. C. experience, and the Area now has a Secretary & Treasurer. A monthly newsletter is sent to all groups (prepared by the Delegate) and an informative State Directory has been published. In three of the State's six Areas, "intergroup" meetings have been held as a means of bringing members closer together in State that only recently has become aware of importance of Third Legacy.

First State Convention was held in 1956. Conventions are largely financed through a special plan of pledges (\$3 to \$20 per month, depending on group size) which give members of such groups privilege of participating in Conventions without payment of registration fees. (Plan also eliminates financial burden from prospective host communities.) The plan has worked well and is believed responsible for growing interest in Third Legacy work in the State. (Members of non-pledging groups pay a small registration fee.)

NORTHEASTERN OHIO

Area was "cradle of A.A." but interest in Conference activity was negligible for many years, although local service needs have been met successfully.

Of 215 groups in Area, only 40 responded when present Delegate called his first meeting two years ago, indicating vital importance of G. S. R. in local Conference work.

Due to "legwork" of one dedicated member, Area groups were persuaded to appoint G. S. R.s at second meeting, about a year later, 210 groups were represented, most of them by G. S. R.s.

First State Convention was held last year. Area was not too well represented but the aftermath was significant. Delegate began to receive many calls from groups demanding to know who their G. S. R. was. This led to a policy of asking groups to select G. S. R.s on basis of willingness to work rather than solely on basis of length of sobriety in A. A.

Questions and Answers

Delegates to each Conference are encouraged to ask the most searching questions regarding General Service Office and A.A. world services. Delegates who hesitate to ask questions from the floor may pose their queries (anonymously, if desired) through the now-famous "Askit-Basket."

Following are among the more pertinent questions raised at the 1958 Conference:

Anonymity

1. Did the publishers of "Look" Magazine receive the most recent G.S.O. mailing on anonymity? (This question apparently relates to a series of articles by a self-disclosed A.A. member.)

Yes. All major publications received the mailing.

Braille

2. Does G.S.O. have literature in Braille for the blind?

G.S.O. has no Braille editions of A.A. literature. Some literature, notably the *Big Book* and *Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions*, is available from other sources. All inquiries are referred to them.

Membership

3. Two different membership figures are shown on page three of the 1958 World Directory. Which is correct? The correct figure for reported membership is 139,795.

Reserve Fund

4. Has the ceiling on the Reserve Fund (\$300,000) been raised to compensate for ever-increasing costs? If not, why not?

No change has been considered since no proposal has been made to change the decision of the 1954 Conference.

Badges

5. At future Conferences, can Delegates' badges be marked to indicate "first-year" and "second-year Delegates?"

This will be done.

Hotel

6. Why was the meeting place of the Conference changed from the Commodore Hotel to the Prince George Hotel?

Principally in an attempt to reduce expenses and because the Commodore could not handle the Conference on the dates needed.

Birthday Plan

7. Should more stress be placed on the Birthday Plan whereby members donate \$1.00 per year of sobriety (up to an agreed limit) for the support of world services?

Referred to the Budgetary & Finance Committee.

Mailing Costs

8. Why can't the "Exchange Bulletin" and other bulletins be mailed for 2 cents instead of 3 cents? Since no names are mentioned in the "Bulletin," no anonymity break would be involved. Substantial savings could result from the lower-priced mailings.

Anonymity is not the only problem involved. Much mail sent at the 2 cent rate does not reach the group for which it is intended and is returned to G.S.O. rather than being forwarded. The problem is being studied but right now first class mail seems best for the movement as a whole.

Wording

9. In the third Tradition, why is the word "honest" omitted from the phrase "honest desire to stop drinking"?

Discussion of this topic centered on the fact that as A.A. has matured, it has been increasingly recognized that it is nearly impossible to determine what constitutes an "honest" desire to stop drinking, as opposed to other forms in which the desire might be expressed. It was also noted that some who may be interested in the program might be confused by the phrase "honest desire." Thus, as part of the evolution of A.A., the descriptive adjective has been dropped.

Wording (2)

10. Why not change the wording of the so-called "Grapevine description" of the movement so that this conforms with the third Tradition in omitting the word "honest"?

This is being done in new editions of A.A. literature. Both Question 9 and Question 10 were referred to the Literature Committee for consideration.

Bulletin

11. How can information contained in the "Exchange Bulletin" be presented to members of a group?

Discussion disclosed a variety of methods being used. In some Areas, highlights from the "Bulletin" are read at group meetings. Some groups post copies on bulletin boards. Others display them in special group libraries and direct the group's attention to them. A number of groups are encouraging members to obtain individual subscriptions (\$1.00 per year) or arrange to obtain such subscriptions for all members of the group.

Literature

12. Since so many groups seem to buy literature from sources other than A.A.P., would it not be practical for G.S.O. to distribute literature order blanks to the groups more often and, in addition, prepare a special pamphlet describing the pamphlet literature now available?

Referred to the Literature Committee.

Travel Expenses

13. In the Third Legacy Manual it is stated: "The Assembly is responsible for the Delegates' travel expense up to \$100. (Amounts in excess of this, together with room and meal expense at New York, are defrayed out of General Service Board Funds.) Did Canadian Delegates receive reimbursement for expenses in excess of \$100?"

The expenses of Canadian Delegates are handled by G.S.O. in the same manner as expenses of other qualified Delegates.

Travel Expenses (2)

14. Should Delegates from Alaska, Puerto Rico and Hawaii (who are now required to pay their own transportation) pay all their travel expenses to and from the Conference?

Referred to the Committees on Policy and Finance.

Travel Expenses (3)

15. Why shouldn't all travel expenses of Delegates be paid by the Areas, thus saving G.S.O. several thousand dollars.

Before referring this question to the Finance Committee, it was noted that such a policy might result in continuing financial hardships for groups in certain remote areas.

Counseling

16. What is the consensus of opinion regarding an A.A. member accepting employment as an industrial consultant or counselor on alcoholism.

This question has been raised at many previous Conferences and is answered in the Final Report for 1957 (Page 35).

Traditionally, A. A.s accept such employment as individuals, *not* as A. A. members.

Industry

17. What other companies have instituted so-called "A.A. programs" in addition to DuPont, Eastman Kodak and Allis Chalmers?

This question was referred to Dr. John L. Norris, non-alcoholic Trustee, who identified several additional companies.

Industry (2)

18. How does one get such a program started in a company?

It was agreed there is no set pattern for such ventures, that they should not be undertaken in the name of A.A. despite the fact that elements of so-called A.A. therapy are employed and that individual members should proceed slowly in such projects.

Directory

19. Can group meeting nights be listed in the World Directory?

This would be impractical. Meeting nights are changed too frequently. The cost of keeping the additional information up to date would be prohibitive.

Directory (2)

20. Is there any reason why prison groups cannot be listed by name in the World Directory?

There are a number of reasons. The principal one is that it has been found that institutional regulations often do not permit visitors or mail.

Old-Timers

21. Would it be possible to publish a G.S.O. pamphlet designed to help the old-timer who has a slip and then has a difficult time re-achieving sobriety?

Referred to the Literature Committee.

Subscriptions

22. As a means of increasing the number of individual subscriptions to the "Exchange Bulletin," could a small subscription order blank be inserted on the last page of each issue?

Referred to the Literature Committee. ("Individual subscription" offer now appears in page 1 box.)

Terms

23. Would 7 Delegate be worth more to A.A. if he served three years instead of two?

There was general agreement that it would not be desirable to increase Delegates' terms in the immediate future. (Panel 7 Delegates to be polled on subject.)

Envelopes

24. Shouldn't Delegates who mail copies of Area meeting reports to Committeemen and others use plain envelopes? Agreed this should be done.

Publications

25. What consideration, if any, has been given to combining the "Exchange Bulletin" and the "Grapevine?"

This has not been considered seriously to date. Matter was referred to the Editorial Board of the "Grapevine."

Staff

26. Is there an unwritten rule against hiring men as Staff members in the General Service Office? If there is no such rule why are men not considered for such positions? Would a capable man be considered in the event of a vacancy?

There is no established rule. Over the years, experience has shown that it is more economical to hire women as Staff members and there are indications that women have special aptitudes for the type of duties involved. (One man has applied for such a position and his application is currently on file.)

Procedure

27. Is it fitting for the chairman to "instigate" a motion while serving in the chair?

The chairman pointed out that it was not his intention to direct the actions of the Conference in any way and that his only purpose in occasionally asking for a motion was to crystallize already apparent sentiment on a particular question.

Trustee Ratio

28. Did every Delegate receive a copy of Bill's letter on the proposal to change the ratio of alcoholic and non-alcoholic Trustees?

The letter was mailed to all Delegates. Eight reported they had not received a copy.

Trustee Ratio (2)

29. Who was responsible for the note, attached to Bill's letter on the Trustee ratio change, in which the letter was described as confidential and not for general discussion in the Areas?

The G.S.O. was responsible.

Industry (3)

30. Does industry have a rehabilitation and hospital program in cooperation with Alcoholics Anonymous?

No formal program of this type exists since A.A. cooperates but does not affiliate with outside agencies or institutions. Programs of this type are considered likely to be more successful if they are not restricted to the use of A.A. members.

Spouses

31. At future Conferences, would it be possible for wives and husbands of Delegates to participate in the closing luncheon on Sunday.

After discussing this matter, the Conference agreed to reject the proposal for reasons of expense and because the Sunday meeting is a "business session" of the conference.

Social

32. Can social activities for Delegates (arranged by hosts in the New York area) be scheduled to avoid conflicts with evening sessions of the Conference?

This matter will be brought to the attention of potential hosts in the area.

Admissions

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS TO THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE:

1. In reference to a resolution presented to the Committee by a Delegate from Michigan, we submit the following:
 - A. Area Committees within each State or Province shall have the authority to remove any Delegate, alternate Delegate or Committeeman for any interruption of sobriety occurring during his term of service to the General Service Conference.
 - B. In the event that such action is taken, the Conference Admissions Committee shall be notified so that his replacement may be recognized and seated at the Conference.
2. In reference to an application for an additional Delegate from some groups in Illinois:
 - A. The Admissions Committee comprised of members of Panels 7 and 8 feels obliged to honor the "Guide for Future Admissions Committees" as expressed in the final report of the Panels 6 and 7.
 - B. We find that the Delegates from the State of Illinois have not complied with those requests and neither by virtue of the factors of population nor mileage can be granted an additional Delegate at this time.
 - C. We re-affirm the recommendation contained in the report of Panels 6 and 7 that the Committee cannot in any measure decide how State divisions shall be made or how Delegates shall be elected—while we do recommend that the Third Legacy plan of election be used to "avoid conflict between local and World Service" (Third Legacy Manual, Section 6, paragraph #8).
3. In reference to an application from all present Delegates from the State of California:
 - A. Resolved, that since the various California District Assemblies have complied with all requests of the Admissions Committee in their application for an additional Delegate, that request is granted, thus allotting the State of California five Delegates to the General Service Conference.
 - B. It is suggested however that, since this additional Delegate will serve an area contiguous with Los Angeles, he and the Los Angeles Delegate be elected in alternate years.
 - C. This leaves to the discretion of the California Assemblies the alternative of electing the fifth Delegate to be seated for one year in Panel 9 or for two years in Panels 10 and 11. A report of their decision shall be forwarded to the Conference Secretary at the earliest possible date.
4. A guide for future Admissions Committees concerning the admissions of Delegates from Puerto Rico, Alaska, and Possessions of the United States will be found in the Policy Committee report from Panels 7 and 8.
5. We further recommend to all future Committees that they earnestly study the Admissions Committee Fact File, always being cognizant of the fact that the Conference by virtue of an increased number of Delegates is in danger of becoming unwieldy and unfair to all A. A. members.

Report adopted unanimously.

Committees of the 1958 Conference

AGENDA

- J. P. Muse, Southeast Texas
- Jack Sargent, Western Pennsylvania
- Ernest Ayers, Virginia
- Pearl Nikkinen, North Minnesota
- Charles Highly, Puerto Rico
- Cec Corrigan, Sask., Canada
- (Eve M.—Sec.)

ADMISSIONS TO CONFERENCE

- Niles Doolittle, Iowa
- William R. Henderson, Northeast Texas
- Horace Hand, Eastern Pennsylvania
- Glenn Walters, Idaho
- Earle O'Hagan, South New Jersey
- Jean Norris, Mississippi
- (Eve M.—Cal M.—Sec.)

CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

- Willard Pegg, North Carolina
- Alf Swenson, Southern Minnesota
- Ruben Jay, Oklahoma
- N. D. (Lib) Libby, Oregon
- Ben Edgerton, San Diego, California
- Harry Nabinger, Mohawk-Hudson, New York
- (Hazel R.—Sec.)

FINANCE

- Howard Bennhoff, Northeastern, Ohio
- Harry Gates, Indiana
- Dan Crouch, Nevada
- Ralph Seward, N. W. Ohio & S. E. Mich. & Ohio
- Louis Mulherin, Georgia
- George Webster, Montana
- Sum C.—Anita R.—Sec.)

GRAPEVINE

- James Wilson, Colorado
- Pete Wolfe, Central & Southeastern, Ohio
- John Rose, Connecticut
- Duane Rolofson, No. Interior Counties, Calif.
- John L. Medak, Joliet, Illinois
- Viv Ingle, South Carolina
- (Joe F.—Louise S.—Sec.)

LITERATURE

- Mark Russell, B. C., Canada
- Paul Gardner, No. Coastal Countries, Calif.
- Ed McNulty, Central, New York
- Joe Lucas, New Mexico
- John Finton, Western Massachusetts
- Rufus W. Smith, Tennessee
- (Lyb S.—Sec.)

POLICY

- Chan Forman, Chicago, Illinois
- Jim Oldham, Washington
- Glenn Christianson, Los Angeles, California
- Charles Butler, Southwest Texas
- Clarence Martin, Maryland
- Tom Zenor, South Dakota
- (Ann M.—Sec.)

TRUSTEES

- Adrian Frylink, Southeastern, New York
- L. W. Noraworthy, North Florida
- Ted Raymond, Southern Wisconsin
- Ladd Skinner, South & Southwest, Ohio
- William Wallace, Kentucky
- Sam Vosburgh, Nebraska
- Jane F.—Sec.)
- Chairman

Policy

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON POLICY:

1. The Committee: Recommends that the matter of a correct membership census be left up to the discretion of local groups with the added suggestion that the local group endeavor to obtain an inclusive count as far as is possible that would indicate not only those members now participating, but also those presently sober in A.A. who are not known to have affiliated with other groups. It is further recommended that each Delegate incorporate in his report to his Area the need for an accurate census and stress the importance of this matter.
2. Recommends that the Delegate incorporate in his report to his Area the importance of a permanent group mailing address with the added suggestion that this be a P. O. Box whenever practicable.
3. Recommends that the suggestion of the name change from General Service Headquarters to General Service Office be adopted.
4. Concurs in the decision of the Conference concerning the re-affirmation of the 1955 Anonymity Resolution.
5. Concurs in the decision of the Conference in reference to the 1960 Convention.
6. Recommends that the participation of institutional groups in the Conference structure be left to the discretion of local Conference Assemblies.
7. Affirms the adoption of the name "International Convention" for the 1960 Convention.
8. Was unable to reach a conclusion concerning the length of term of Delegates, but recommends that a poll of panel 7 Delegates be taken to determine their reactions.
9. Recommends that accredited Delegates from U. S. Territories, possessions and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico should receive the same financial considerations as the Delegates from the United States and Canada; as these Delegates have been accepted by the Conference as a part of the present Conference structure.

Report adopted unanimously.

Trustees

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES:

1. The Conference Committee on Trustees recommends adoption of nominations as suggested by the General Service Board Nominating Committee. (See page 27.)
2. This Committee also recommends that consideration be given to the possibility of removing from our by-laws the requirement that Class B Trustees sign a blank resignation at the time of their election and/or qualification.

Report adopted unanimously.

Report and Charter

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee on the Conference Report and Charter recommends that the first draft of the 1958 final Conference Report be referred to members of their Committee for consideration, suggestions and corrections as soon as it is completed.

Committee members will review and return the draft within a week so that the mailing of the final Conference Report will not be unduly delayed.

Report adopted unanimously.

Finance

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON FINANCE:

The Committee is cognizant of these facts:

1. Operation of A.A.'s General Service Office agencies resulted in a net loss in 1957.
2. The budget submitted to this Conference forecasts group contributions insufficient to balance operating expenses of G. S. O. for 1958.
3. Many groups do not contribute to G. S. O. at all.
4. Many individuals A. A.s contribute through the Birthday Plan.
5. Individual A. A.s have sent in contributions in response to exploratory letters written by a few A. A.s to old friends no longer active in group work.

However, this Committee believes that when there is a real need in our Fellowship, this need will be met when the members are fully informed.

Furthermore, we have at hand through our present structure the ways and means of informing our members of this need.

Therefore, the Finance Committee has adopted this plan: Each Delegate member of the Finance Committee will fully instruct his Area committeemen and Group Representatives at meetings within the next few weeks that each member of each group will be expected to contribute 4 cents a week minimum, collectible quarterly, for the maintenance of A.A. World Services at G. S. O. The General Service Representative will be responsible for sending the money to G. S. O. Each Delegate will repeat this mouth-to-ear appeal during the year.

We would like to have several more Delegates, both panel 7 and panel 8, help us to meet the need for wider participation in group contributions.

The Committee suggests all areas with Birthday Plan experience forward data to Anita Ryan at G. S. O. where a file will be opened to collate this material for presentation to the 1959 Conference.

The Committee agrees that a voluntary pilot plan of letters from A.A.s to their friends who no longer contribute to G.S.O. through their groups—close friends who are no longer as active in their group as formerly—should be cleared through G.S.O. to prevent duplications.

Report adopted unanimously.

Agenda

REPORT OF THE AGENDA COMMITTEE:

The Committee:

1. Voted to accept the Conference Agenda as is, except to recommend that one full afternoon is too much time to devote to the *Grapevine*. The *Grapevine* report should be condensed to cover important facts concerning finances, circulation, the trends of both and what we can do about them.
2. Recommended continuation of G. S. O. briefing sessions for new Delegates prior to opening of Conference deliberations.
3. Expressed gratitude to Hazel Rice and Hank Grieme for their efforts in behalf of the 1958 Conference.
4. Agreed to review proposals during the coming year, with appropriate advices to G. S. O.

Report adopted unanimously.

Literature

REPORT OF CONFERENCE LITERATURE COMMITTEE:

The following recommendations are presented to the Conference by the Literature Committee:

1. Considered the possibility of a pamphlet to include case histories for the skid row alcoholic, a pamphlet that ought to be available in jails, and concluded that there is no need for such a pamphlet at the present time since:
 - a. In general, A.A. groups cooperate with local jails either through a sponsorship arrangement or jail meetings.
 - b. Present pamphlet literature offers adequate A.A. reading material for the alcoholic in jail who desires to do something about his problem.
 - c. The responsibility for placing information about A.A. in local jails is a matter for local A.A. groups and service committees.
2. Since the use of tokens of sobriety is a matter of local taste and custom, there seems to be no expressed need at the present time for a standard token of sobriety and no need for A.A. Publishing, Inc. to carry such an item.
3. Approved the recommendation that A.A. Publishing, Inc. provide for a basic A.A. book in foreign languages as needed.
4. Recognized the original use of the word "honest" before "desire to stop drinking" and its deletion from the Traditions as part of the evolution of the A.A. movement. Any change to be left to the discretion of A.A. Publishing, Inc.
5. Since there seems no need for a pamphlet to describe A.A. pamphlets, recommend that the idea be dropped. However, suggest that an item about A.A. Publishing, Inc. pamphlet literature might be run in the A.A. Exchange Bulletin from time to time. Think that the present distribution of order blanks in a general mailing twice a year, and with each order of literature, is sufficient.
6. Think that the present announcement of subscription rate on the front page of the A.A. Exchange Bulletin is sufficient, and that a subscription blank would only take space from a news item.
7. Recommend the Brief History in the Third Legacy Manual to those who want a history of A.A. in pamphlet form.
8. Do not think there is sufficient need for A.A. Publishing, Inc. to distribute a portable literature rack since local areas take care of their own needs and display their literature to suit their own needs.
9. Refer to A.A. Publishing, Inc. the suggestion that their two individual waller cards be replaced when the present supply is exhausted by one fold-over card that would include the same material now on the two cards.
10. Approve the concept that A.A. Publishing, Inc. distribute for a year specially-priced literature packages of books and pamphlets and report the results to next year's Conference.

11. Do not feel that there is a need for a special pamphlet for the inmate member in prisons and jails. Recommend that the staff member handling Institutional Services encourage the exchange of prison group experiences and publications to meet any need expressed by an individual prison group.
12. Do not feel that an animated "comic book" type pamphlet is appropriate for A.A. literature.
13. Recommend that the "Oldtimer" pamphlet be tabled for the present time since after a year of exploration there is inadequate material to warrant publication.
14. The Literature Committee would like to go on record that the pamphlet literature distributed by A.A. Publishing is adequate at the present time and that before developing any new pamphlets the need for each one should be well defined.
15. Recommends that the Survey of Armed Forces Groups be continued with the view to developing material that can be given to Commanding Officers of Armed Forces Bases so that they may understand the role that A.A. plays in the recovery of alcoholics in the Armed Services.

Report adopted unanimously.

Grapevine

THE 1958 GRAPEVINE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDS:

1. Occasional use of 48 pages when feasible and necessary in the judgement of the Grapevine Board of Directors.
2. That a middle-of-the-road plan of circulation stimulation be followed with the Delegate and his respective committees carrying the major portion of the effort.
3. That the three-fold card for individuals be used in a test area with Delegates and their Committees also participating. Delegates will be supplied with the above forms in time to incorporate same with their area reports.
4. That heavy intensive promotions be opposed but, that some form of continuous "reminders" be used as needed and at the discretion of the Grapevine Board of Directors.
5. That, while it is realized that articles for sale should pay their own way, it be recognized that under present conditions this may not be possible in the case of the Grapevine for some time.
6. That the \$10,000 previously authorized by the Trustees, which to date has not been used, be maintained as a reserve fund for emergency purposes.

The Committee also noted:

Paid staff members only increased by one since Grapevine changed to 64 pages. Although staff shows several editors, etc., most of these are of voluntary service. Grapevine art and/or cover expenses: this has never been an expense as same is again of a voluntary nature. Change in type: this was caused by our printer who changed his facilities and made the service available to us for only a fraction more than previously paid.

Report adopted unanimously.

1958 Conference Delegates

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ALABAMA	(7) <i>Hiers, Jim E.</i> 2406 Woodview Drive, S. E., Huntsville	MICHIGAN	(7) East— <i>Golden, Daniel</i> , 19264 Omira St., Detroit 3
ARIZONA	(8) <i>Davis, John W.</i> , 4036 E. Fairmont, Phoenix		(7) Central— <i>Davidson, George</i> , 1436 Birney Street, Saginaw
ARKANSAS	(7) <i>Porter, James S.</i> , 300 Rector Street, Little Rock		(8) West— <i>Walker, George</i> , (Cbi), 1015 N. Park St., Kalamazoo
CALIFORNIA	(7) Los Angeles — <i>Christianson, Glenn</i> , 2390 Glen Canyon Rd., Altadena	MINNESOTA	(8) North — <i>Nikkinen, Mrs. John H. (Pearl)</i> , 1124 E. Washington St., Ely
	(8) San Diego— <i>Edgerton, Ben</i> 612 East 8th Street, National City		(7) South— <i>Swenson, Alf A.</i> , Wilder
	(8) No. Interior Counties — <i>Rolofson, Duane</i> , 1404 Vernon Ave., Modesto	MISSISSIPPI	(8) <i>Norris, Jean</i> , Box 283, Indianola
	(7) No. Coastal Counties— <i>Gardner, Paul</i> , 1612 Fourth St., San Rafael	MISSOURI	(7) East— <i>Robertson, Kelley A.</i> , 106 No. High Street, California
COLORADO	(7) <i>Wilson, James L.</i> , 4154 Xavier Street, Denver 12	MONTANA	(7) West— <i>Paxton, Earl</i> , 710 West Second St., Sedalia
CONNECTICUT	(7) <i>Rose, John J.</i> , 34 Deepwood Drive, Cheshire	NEBRASKA	(8) <i>Webster, George</i> , 375 Daly Ave., Missoula
DELAWARE	(8) <i>Mullin, MacSumner</i> , 1406 Philadelphia Pike, Wilmington		(8) <i>Vosburgh, H. M. (Sam)</i> , Box 500, Kearney
DISTRICT OF COL.	(7) <i>Stonebraker, Barse</i> , 1835 K St., N.W., Washington, D. C.	NEVADA	(7) <i>Crouch, Dan</i> , Apt. 12, 430 Maryland Parkway, Las Vegas
FLORIDA	(7) North — <i>Norsworthy, L. W. (Pap)</i> , Box 673, Neptune Beach	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(8) <i>Ratcliffe, William</i> , 95 Winter Street, Rochester
	(7) South — <i>Parrish, Wesley</i> , Box 246, Pompano Beach	NEW JERSEY	(7) North — <i>Anderson, Tom</i> , 152 Grove Avenue, Woodbridge
GEORGIA	(8) <i>Mulherin, Louis</i> , 1211 Peachtree Road, Augusta	NEW MEXICO	(8) South— <i>O'Hagen, Earle</i> , 154 Terttemer Ave., Trenton 10
IDAHO	(8) <i>Walters, Glen</i> , Sugar City	NEW YORK	(8) <i>Lucas, Joe</i> , 701 S. Michigan, Roswell
ILLINOIS	(7) Chicago— <i>Forman, Chandler</i> , 848 Ridge Ave., Evanston		(7) Southeastern— <i>Frylink, Adrian</i> , Box 66, Babylon
	(8) Decatur— <i>Medak, John L.</i> , RFD 2 Box 251 (Forest Hills), Lockport		(8) Western — <i>Kennedy, David</i> , 458 Best Street, Buffalo
	(7) Springfield— <i>Ansell, Oscar</i> , 1829 South Pasfield, Springfield	NORTH CAROLINA	(8) Mohawk-Hudson — <i>Nabinger, Harry</i> , 324 Alplaus,, Alplaus
INDIANA	(7) <i>Cates, Harry</i> , 313 South Meridan St., Washington		(7) Central— <i>McNulty, Ed</i> , 761 Valentine Street, Elmira
IOWA	(7) <i>Doolittle, Niles</i> , 609 Otsego St., Storm Lake	NORTH DAKOTA	(7) <i>Pegg, Willard</i> , 1911 Spring Garden Street, Greensboro
KANSAS	(8) <i>Brown, Dr. V. D.</i> , 1404 E. Kellogg, Wichita		(8) <i>Marschke, Gus</i> , 1112 2nd Avenue, N., Fargo
KENTUCKY	(8) <i>Wallace, William</i> , 13 Lelia St., Jeffersonville, Indiana	OHIO	(7) Central & Southeastern— <i>Wolfe, Pete</i> , Gahanna
LOUISIANA	(8) <i>Kelley, Thomas B.</i> , Box 1612, Shreveport		(8) N. W. Ohio & S. E. Mich.— <i>Seward, Ralph</i> , Manitou Beach, Michigan
MAINE	(8) <i>Knight, George</i> , 42 Green Street, Westbrook	OKLAHOMA	(7) Northeastern — <i>Bennhoff, Howard</i> , West Richfield, (P. O. Box 456)
MARYLAND	(8) <i>Martin, Clarence A.</i> , 2105 S. Governor Ritchie Highway, Glen Burnie	OREGON	(8) South & Southwest — <i>Skinner, Ladd</i> , 1111 Delta Ave., Cincinnati 8
MASSACHUSETTS	(7) Eastern— <i>Ryan, Ned</i> , 9 Emerson Street Belmont	PENNSYLVANIA	(7) <i>Jay, Ruben</i> , 501 Washington, Stillwater
	(8) Western— <i>Finton, John. J.</i> , 123 Essex Street, Springfield		(8) <i>Libby, N. D. (Lib)</i> , 1820 "T" St., Springfield
			(7) East— <i>Hand, Horace S.</i> , 312 West 4th St., Williamsport
			(7) West — <i>Sargent, Jack</i> , 220 Emerson Ave., Pittsburgh 15

1958 Conference Delegates

(Continued)

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RHODE ISLAND	(8) <i>Head, John (Red)</i> , 132 Cato Street, Woonsocket	WISCONSIN	(7) Southern Wisc. — <i>Raymond, Theodore C.</i> , 323 West Wilson St., Madison
SOUTH CAROLINA	(8) <i>Ingle, Viv</i> , P. O. Box 477, Moncks Corner		(8) N. Wisc. & Upper Mich. — <i>Simon, Carl F.</i> , Route 4, Stevens Point
SOUTH DAKOTA	(8) <i>Zenor, Thomas</i> , 2918 Dundee Street, Rapid City	WYOMING	(8) <i>Barber, Paul</i> , 152 North Beech, Casper
TENNESSEE	(8) <i>Smith, Rufus W.</i> , West Washington St., Fayetteville	CANADA	(8) Alberta — <i>Parton, Ken</i> , #18 - Moreuille Wood Dr., Calgary, S. W.
TEXAS	(7) Northeast — <i>Henderson, William R.</i> , 1614 N. Fitzhugh, Dallas		(7) B. C. — <i>Russell, Mark</i> , 21 Government St., Victoria
	(7) Southeast — <i>Muse, J. P.</i> , 2007 Chippendale, Houston		(8) Manitoba — <i>Monson, J. Willard</i> , Box 849, Dauphin
	(8) Southwest — <i>Butler, J. C.</i> , (Charlie), Box 173, Ozona		(8) Atlantic Provinces — <i>MacLeod, Ian</i> , Box 143, Baddeck, Nova Scotia
	(8) Northwest — <i>Titus, C. B.</i> , 1027 Coble Drive or Box 536, Borger		(8) Ontario-Western — <i>Guenther, Lee</i> , 158 Herbert St., Waterloo
UTAH	(7) <i>Quick, Leo</i> , 2240 South 9th East, Salt Lake City		(7) Ontario-Eastern — <i>McVicar, Neil</i> , Delcourt Apts., Apt. 44, 1798 Eglinton Avenue, West Toronto
VERMONT	(8) <i>Supple, John</i> , Mapleleaf Farm, Underhill		(8) Quebec — <i>Hinman, Bess</i> , 3980 Cote des Neiges Rd., Montreal 25
VIRGINIA	(7) <i>Ayers, Ernest L.</i> , 211 West Little Creek Road, Norfolk	PUERTO RICO	(8) Saskatchewan — <i>Corrigal, Cec.</i> , 665 Blvd. Drive, Prince Albert
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			Norway — <i>Sonju, Hart</i> , 1117 East Earl St., Philadelphia, Pa.



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Grand Central Station

New York 17, N. Y.

* The Conference approved the report of the G. S. B. nominating Committee recommending the election of Alfred Steckman as a Class B (A.A.) Trustee, the reelection of all other Trustees and the election of officers as indicated.



The 1958 Conference Report is the first to be printed by letterpress. Previous reports have been typewritten and then reproduced by a photo-offset process. The new format makes it possible to present more detailed reports and to do so more attractively and with less bulk. It also makes possible substantial dollar savings by G. S. O.